

PAKISTAN

Consulting Services for Regional Infrastructure Fund for Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (RIF-II) for Resilient Resource Management in Cities

Quarterly Progress Report 04

Reporting period May – July 2025

Project Number: BMZ No. 2018 68 355 / KfW ID: 42975 Procurement Number 508317

Co-Financing: KfW Development Bank, Frankfurt/Germany

Client:

Planning and Development Department (P&DD)
of the Provincial Government of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa

Submitted by:

Dorsch Impact GmbH - NEC - CYNOSURE

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As Sub-Consultant:



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List of Abbreviations

AC	Assistant Commissioner
ACS	Additional Chief Secretary
AD	Assistant Director
CSO	Civil Society Organization
DC	Deputy Commissioner
DPO	District Police Officer
ESHS	Environmental, Social and Health Safety
FGD	Focus Group Discussion
FMG	Financial Management Guide
GIS	Geographic Information System
GoKP	Government of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa
GoP	Government of Pakistan
PIC	Project Implementation Consultants
KfW	German Development Bank
KP	Khyber Pakhtunkhwa
LG	Local Government
LGERDD	Local Government, Elections and Rural Development Department
M&E	Monitoring & Evaluation
MIS	Management Information System
MoU	Memorandum of Understanding
NC	Neighbourhood Council
NGO	Non-Governmental Organization
NOC	Non-Objection Certificate
O&M	Operation and Maintenance
P&DD	Planning and Development Department
PCA	Peace and Conflict Assessment
PD	Project Director
PHED	Public Health Engineering Department
PKR	Pakistani Rupee
PMU	Project Management Unit
RMO	Regional Municipality Officer
RRMiC	Resilient Resource Management in Cities
RRM	Resilient Resource Management
SLF	Sanitary Landfill
SWM	Solid waste management
TMA	Tehsil Municipal Administration
TMO	Tehsil Municipal Officer
TOI	Tehsil Officer Infrastructure
TOR	Terms of References
UMA	Unmanned Aerial Systems
UPPU	Urban Policy & Planning Unit
VC	Village Council

KEY DATA

Project Name	Consulting Services for Regional Infrastructure Fund for Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (RIF-II) for Resilient Resource Management in Cities
Project Region	Pakistan, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa Districts D.I. Khan and Bannu
BMZ-No.	2018 68 355 KfW ID: 42975 Procurement Number 508317
Client/Project Executing Agency	Urban Policy & Planning Unit (UPPU), Planning and Development Department (P&DD) of the Provincial Government of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa
Financing Institution	Kreditanstalt für Wiederaufbau (KfW)
Consultant	Consortium comprising: Dorsch Impact GmbH (lead), Germany, NEC Consultants (Pvt.) Limited, Pakistan, Cynosure Consultants (Pvt). Ltd., Pakistan Sub-consultant BORDA e.V, Germany
Essential Contractual Data	
PIC Contract date	17/06/2024
PIC Commencement date	01/08/2024
Expected completion date	30/06/2029 (optional services 5 months after June 2029)
Elapsed time	12 months
Amount of Consulting Contract (€)	4,321,329 €
Invoiced Amount (€)	832.548,20 €
Total Programme Funds (€)	21.000.000 € (FC Grant: 17.500.000 € and exec. Agency 3.500.000 €)

1. Project Background

The Regional Infrastructure Fund (RIF–II) is implemented under the Resilient Resource Management in Cities (RRMiC) framework, following a successful pilot in , Mansehra District¹, KP. Expanding in scale and scope, RIF–II intends to cover nine tehsil towns in Bannu and Dera Ismail Khan (D.I. Khan) districts, focusing on integrated water supply, wastewater, and solid waste management. RIF-II promotes the integration of the sectors of water supply, wastewater and solid waste management for the improvement of function of the overall urban services system. The integrated approach also means that government, stakeholders and social actors must be participants of the whole process (starting from assessment, planning, designing, implementation, until operation and maintenance). It also entails that community leaders are empower and it also includes the vulnerable groups like women, whose capacities are strengthened and awareness raising has been done to an adequate level. For ensuring resilience and long-term sustainability, these conditionalities are inescapable requirements.

Resilient Resource Management means sustainable water use and conservation through wastewater reduction and treatment, minimizing water losses, promoting reuse, increasing storage, and enhancing management and operational efficiency. This requires training for PHED, TMAs, communities, and relevant departments, coupled with broad-based awareness and sensitization. Given Pakistan’s limited and increasingly polluted water resources—exacerbated by untreated wastewater, unsafe solid waste disposal, and effluent mismanagement—isolated interventions are insufficient. Sustainable solutions demand integrated, multi-sectoral actions within the same geographic areas, such as combining water supply improvements with wastewater treatment, solid waste reduction, and water reuse. Such integration can substantially reduce the environmental, social, and economic impacts of drought under current climate conditions.

1.1. General

RIF – II Project is being implemented in two districts of south-western Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (KP), Bannu and D.I. Khan. The type of potential interventions and the locations will be decided after physical site assessment and consultation with the stakeholders, including the beneficiary communities. Except headquarter tehsils, the Project interventions will be conducted in nine peripheral tehsils based on accessibility assessment in those tehsils. The decision will be based on community consultations through mapping workshops, focus group discussions and a prioritization carried out together with representatives of the communities, local government representatives and other relevant stakeholders (religious leaders, minority representative groups etc.).

¹ RRM Mansehra is in the final phase of its completion, likely to get closed by end June 2025.

1.2. Geographical Locations and Clustering

The two district headquarters in D.I. Khan and Bannu (see Figure 1) are separated by Lakki Marwat and Tank districts, where high security sensitivity imposes travel restrictions: movement is permitted only between sunrise and sunset, with unofficial curfews at night. For administrative and security reasons, Bannu District has been subdivided into two clusters (3a and 3b)².

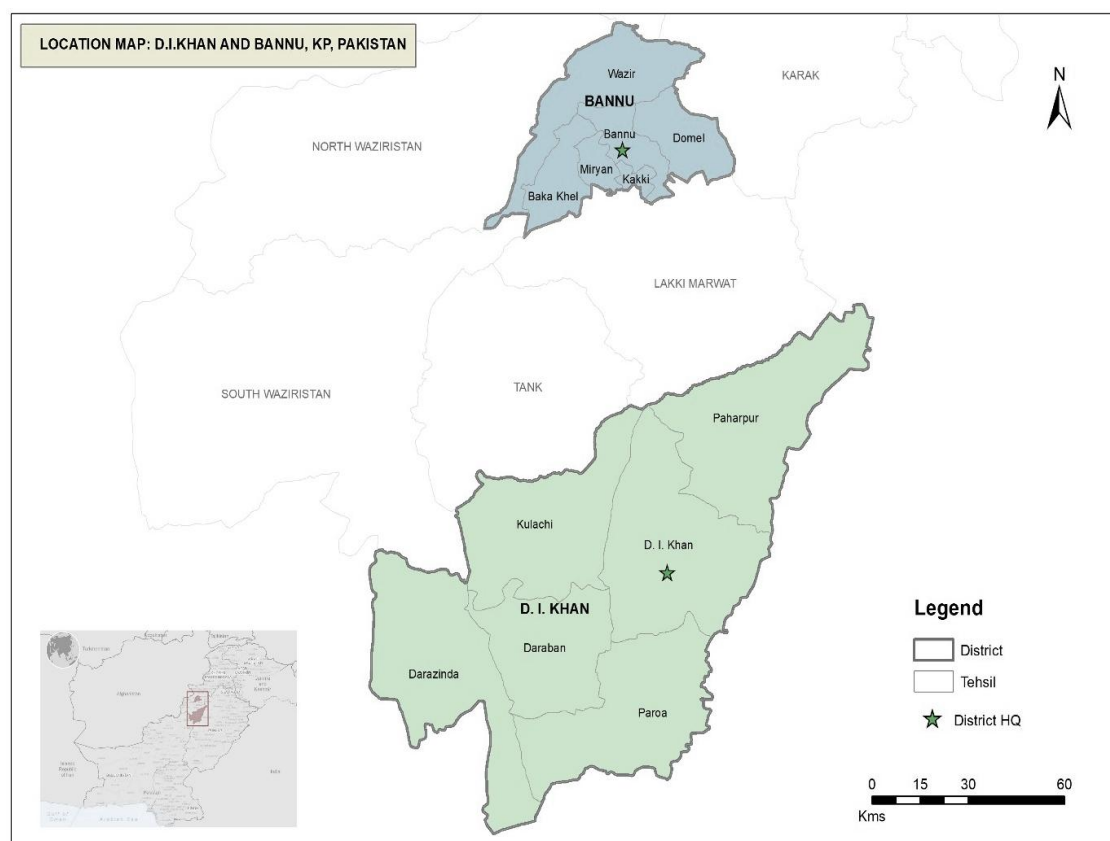


Figure 1: Bannu and D.I. Khan Districts

In D.I. Khan, the five tehsils include urban tehsil towns and Neighbourhood Councils (NCs). In contrast, Bannu's four tehsils have no NCs and are entirely rural, represented by Village Councils (VCs) (see Table 1).

Table 1: Geographical Zones and Project Clusters

District	Cluster No.	Tehsil	NCs	VCs	Remarks
D.I. Khan	Cluster 1	Paharpur	4	41	
		Paroa	1	28	
	Cluster 2	Daraban	2	16	Inaccessible due to security sensitivities.
		Darazinda	1	11	
		Kulachi	6	11	
Bannu	Cluster 3a	Domel	0	14	

² In Sep/Oct 2024, Bannu and Lakki Marwat districts police force went on strike and blocked the main Indus Highway for more than a week, which was followed by a number of protests for another 2 – 3 weeks. For one reason or the other, this road gets blocked very often.

		Kakki	0	15	
	Cluster 3b	Baka Khel	0	13	Inaccessible due to security sensitivities.
		Sub-Division Wazir	0	6	

1.3. Methodology

This section describes the methodology proposed by the project implementation consultants (PIC) to perform their services according to the Terms of Reference (ToRs) and the envisaged Scope of Works (SW). In order to complete this project in the allocated time, it is essential that respective tasks and activities are well planned and coordinated under a comprehensive approach and methodology at all levels to enable timely completion of the Project.

As per the TORs all selected community infrastructure schemes shall be further assessed to arrive at technical designs, Bill of Quantities, drawings, and a firm cost estimate with a realistically anticipated duration from start to completion laid down in a work plan for each selected scheme. The PIC will supervise construction works and supplies on behalf of the Urban Policy and Planning Unit (UPPU), who remains the employers of construction companies and suppliers. These tasks include the site supervision of all works, the preparation of initial operation activities, a continuous monitoring, a periodic reporting, and the participation in the preliminary acceptance.

During the inception phase, which was intended to conclude in by June 2025 but is currently facing delays with activities planned to conclude by November/ December 2025, the PIC is to complete a set of foundational studies and assessments to inform and form the basis of the design and construction phase. These include the following:

- Physical context assessment
- Institutional and stakeholder's context assessment
- Development of action plans for each tehsil
- Base-line surveys on Mohalla level (requires engagement of CSO)
- Social assessment: conflict-sensitive approach
- Development of communication and advocacy strategy, and quick wins
- Identification and prioritization of schemes
- Definition and implementation start of social mobilization strategy (requires engagement of CSO)
- Monitoring framework development
- Environmental and Social Management Framework (ESMF) preparation

1.3.1. Preparation of Base Maps

The PIC's GIS expert is developing multi-scale maps to analyse existing conditions and identify opportunities for infrastructure interventions. Initial mapping focuses on tehsil towns, covering settlement structures and natural resource patterns (e.g., rivers, springs). The process will begin with an overview of water supply, wastewater, and solid waste management infrastructure, gradually adding detail through assessments and mapping workshops. These maps will integrate with P&DD and UPPU databases, complement District Master Plans, and support climate-resilient urban planning by identifying existing infrastructure, potential new sites, and flood-risk areas. They will also aid climate-resilient planning by identifying current infrastructure, potential sites for new schemes, and flood-risk areas to support Climate-Informed Urban Planning.

1.3.2. Baseline Surveys

An integrated baseline survey is planned to gather essential baseline data aligned with project indicators and provide context-specific details for developing detailed designs. This survey will establish pre-project scenarios for each indicator and set benchmarks for measuring project effects and outcomes. The survey will use mixed methods to collect qualitative and quantitative data via household surveys conducted with a semi-structured online questionnaire created in KoBo Toolbox. Data will be gathered using tables for efficient field collection and centralized database analysis. Participatory Rural Appraisal (PRA) tools may also be employed for sectors like solid waste, wastewater, and water supply management. Enumerators, team supervisors, and support staff will receive training, and questionnaires will be field-tested to refine methods for administering Focus Group Discussions (FGDs). The survey will also include questions to inform awareness-raising activities, collecting baseline data on behaviours in pilot areas to design tailored campaigns for behavioural change. This is an essential activity for the M&E of the project and will require the engagement of a local CSO in order to carry out the necessary field work.

1.3.3. Community Participation

The PIC will collaborate with relevant departments and NC/VC representatives to organize and communicate with households. A community activist from each project area will act as a local resource person, supporting social mobilization teams alongside NC/VC representatives. Two local female social mobilization experts will ensure access to households and coordinate surveys. NC/VC representatives will be trained in survey methodology and field plans, contributing to their capacity-building efforts.

2. RIF II Result Matrix

RIF – II is passing through the identification and inception phase. All other follow-up activities will be undertaken after the completion of inception of this phase. The Figure below outlines the three main project phases.

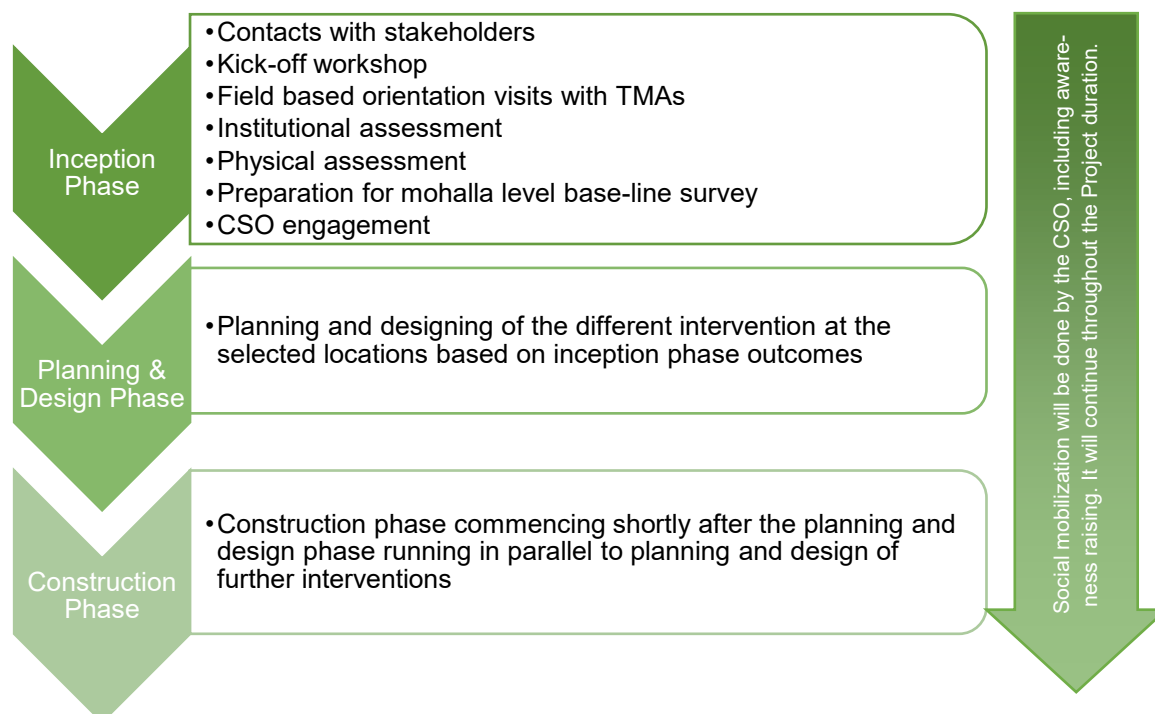


Figure 2: Project Phases

2.1. Overall Output Progress

The overall progress, in terms of percentage (%), for the reported period is presented in the following matrix:

Table 2: Activity Progress Inception Phase

	Activity Description	Percentage (%)	Remarks
1	Contacts with stakeholders.	100	
2	Kick-off workshop.	100	
3	Field based orientation visits with TMAs, PHED and NCs.	50	
4	Institutional assessment.	95	Under review to be submitted by first week of September
5	Physical Assessment	65	Under internal revision of PIC experts
6	Preparations for <i>mohalla</i> level base-line surveys.	5	
7	Pairing of experts, virtual meeting with national and international experts for physical site assessment.	50	
10	Drafting ToRs for hiring the civil society organisation.	75	Approved and with UPPU
11	Administration and logistics, office and transport etc.	55	Office and 1 project car purchased
12	Preparation of a Financial Management Guide	100	Completed

13	Preparation of a draft procurement plan	20	Ongoing
14	Result matrix	40	Under preparation
15	Capacity building concept, workplan and budget	10	Under preparation
16	Stakeholders Engagement Plan (SEP) template and Stakeholders Engagement Framework (SEF) template	45	Under preparation
17	Social mobilization and Awareness Raising Strategy	10	CSO engagement is required. Participatory development workshop planned for August (without CSO)
18	M&E Framework	25	Under preparation
19	Web-based MIS	50	Under preparation
20	Mapping workshop	10	Under preparation
21	List of selected community infrastructure schemes	0	After mapping workshop
22	ESMF and the associated E&S tools and templates	0	Once areas for infrastructure are selected

2.2. Progress per Activity

2.2.1. Activity Progress A

Table 3: Progress (A), until January 2025

Output	Indicator	Sources		
Output A <i>Showcase community infrastructure addressing water supply, affluent and solid waste have been identified, designed, and built.</i>	Indicator: The access of households to community infrastructure has improved. Baseline value: 0 (to be confirmed at inception) Target value: at least one sector project in each selected tehsil town <u>For annual reporting:</u> Current value: Achievable during project duration: yes/no	- Project baseline assessment at inception. - Data and statistics of Tehsil towns. - Planning and approval documents from the provincial Annual Development Plans. - Project progress reviews. - Interviews with households.		
Activity			Overall Progress %	QPR02 Progress %
Activity-A	Select, design, and build schemes for Tehsil towns in D.I. Khan and Bannu districts.			
1.1	Carry out relevant situation analysis and baseline studies for the Tehsil towns concerning available facilities and resources regarding water supply and the management of affluent (sanitation) and solid waste through the Implementation Consultant assigned to the project.		60%	10%
	Institutional and stakeholder's context assessment data enumeration and analysis done, draft report completed		99%	39%
	Physical site assessment field work completed, report under preparation		65%	10%
	Brainstorming session with M&E/MIS experts for developing tracking sheets, along with all the three RIF – II Project disciplines, has been done.		30%	30%
	Baseline design and questionnaire development are planned for the next quarter,		15%	14%
	Social assessment will follow a conflict-sensitive approach to align with local dynamics, once the CSO has been hired. (Not started yet)		0%	0%
	Development of communication and advocacy strategy, and quick wins (Not started yet)		0%	0%
	Identification and prioritization of schemes (Not started yet)		0%	0%
	Security and risk assessment is being done on regular basis for ensuring the safety of Project staff.		ongoing	ongoing
1.2	Conduct the mapping of each Tehsil town showing water sources and potential land for wastewater treatment and landfill sites for solid waste management and waste recycling. - Coordination amongst GIS, MIS and M&E experts. - GIS expert started working on maps. - M&E draft tracking sheets have been developed in consultation with MIS and other experts.		45%	35%
1.3	Rehabilitate and complete selected drainage systems to allow for water treatment		0%	0%
1.4	Rehabilitate selected surface water treatment plants with a special emphasis on appropriate process technologies and protection from solid waste and other pollution.		0%	0%

1.5	Identify the potential for improving selected facilities or suggest replacing facilities regarding water supply/discharge/treatment and solid waste management.	0%	0%
1.6	Develop and assess the availability of water sources (spring, surface, groundwater) for sustainable utilization through appropriate technologies in combination with recommendations to preserve natural resources.	0%	0%
1.7	Promote the separation of solid waste at a household level, waste collection, waste treatment (recycling by manual sorting), composting, and the sanitary landfill (deposition of rejects and residual waste).	0%	0%

2.2.2. Activity Progress B

Table 4: Progress (B), until January 2025

Output	Indicator	Source		
<i>Output B</i> <i>Relevant staff of concerned departments at provincial, district and tehsil level have been supported to increase their capacity (resources and competence) for integrated and coordinated planning.</i>	Indicator: Newly acquired knowhow is applied in department's work. Hiring of dedicated roles and functions to support project objectives. Baseline value: 0 (to be confirmed at inception) Target value: (to be confirmed at inception) <u>For annual reporting:</u> Current value: Achievable during project duration: yes/no	<i>Tbd</i>		
<i>Activity</i>			<i>Overall Progress%</i>	<i>QPR02 Progress %</i>
Activity B	Relevant staff of concerned departments at the provincial, district, and tehsil level have been supported to increase their capacity (resources and competence) for integrated and coordinated planning.		0%	0%
2.1	Support the UPU of KP in the realization of selected results from the Master Planning for Bannu and D.I. Khan		0%	0%
2.2	Develop practise-oriented skills development schemes regarding water and solid waste management		0%	0%
2.3	Advise on the purchase of equipment feasible to address water and solid waste management in Tehsil towns of Bannu and D.I. Khan		0%	0%
2.4	Develop training material and practical trainings on environment protection		0%	0%

2.2.3. Activity Progress C

Table 5: Progress (C), until January 2025

Output	Indicator	Source
<i>Output C</i> <i>Citizen-state dialogue formats have been initiated to offer opportunities for citizen participation in selection, realization, and maintenance of</i>	Indicator: Community participation events have taken place. Baseline value: 0 Target value: 10 <u>For annual reporting:</u> Current value:	- Community development plans - Documentation of events - Project progress review - Interviews with households

community infrastructure schemes.		Achievable during project duration: yes/no		
Activity			Overall Progress%	QPR02 Progress %
Activity C	Initiate citizen-state dialogue and promote citizen participation		0%	0%
3.1	Identify legitimized community representatives reflecting the Tehsil town's composition in terms of social strata, age, and gender.		0%	0%
3.2	Facilitate the involvement of identified community representatives in scheme selection (Activity A).		0%	0%
3.3	Identify community contributions with the community representatives for the realization and maintenance of schemes supported by the project (Activity A).		0%	0%
3.4	Train the communities in sustainable utilization of community infrastructure, natural resources, and the handling of waste.		0%	0%
3.5	Identify additional efforts of the Tehsil towns by the Implementation Consultant and finance through the project.		0%	0%

3. Project Implementation

The following chapter outlines the activities and meetings that occurred during the reporting period.

3.1. Field Visits

Key field visits conducted during this reporting period include:

- Field visits to various accessible tehsils are a routine matter. Such visits are adequately utilized for reviving contacts with various stakeholders, i.e. Deputy Commissioner (DC), Assistant Commissioner (AC), District Police Officer (DPO), PHED, RMO, all the four TMAs, Assistant Director (AD) Local Government, Elections and Rural Development Department (LGERDD), Water Supply, Sanitation Company (WSSC) and others.
- The most significant field activities in both the districts during this quarter had been pertaining to social actors' profiling and mapping. This exercise had successfully been conducted for identifying the potential male and female community activists and volunteers who would bridge the gap between PIC and the beneficiary communities.
- After a prior arrangement, the RIF – II team had visited RRM Mansehra, 11 – 12 June 2025. Objectives of this visit were to seek their coaching and guidance for tendering, procurement, disposition funds and a variety of other matters. The RRM team had made a meticulous preparation and educated the RIF – II team in a very structured and orderly manner. They also made a broad offer that in case of any confusion in the future, RIF – II team can always seek their help and assistance.

3.2. Project Director (PD) visit to RIF – II

The PD from UPPU Mr. Muhammad Saleh, visited the RIF-II office in D.I. Khan (5–7 May 2025) together with a town planner from PMU. This first official visit included briefings on the inception phase, a wholistic picture about the prevalent security scenario in the Project corridor, including the foreseeable future projections and the prevailing security situation. The PD also met with newly appointed DCs of both districts in the presence of relevant stakeholders. Due to time constraints, field-level stakeholder (i.e. TMAs, PHED, AD LGERDD) and others visits could not be conducted but were promised for the near future.

3.3. Meeting with Additional Chief Secretary (ACS)

On 30 June 2025, ACS convened a meeting in Peshawar to review project security related aspects. The PIC, represented by TL Mr. Ayaz Khan and Security Manager Mr. Arif Khan and Project Director Mr Ulrich Sammet (online) presented progress and highlighted security risks, referencing earlier communications followed by a brief presentation of the PD from UPPU Mr. Muhammad Saleh. The ACS affirmed that RIF-II would proceed in its planned locations while assuring strengthened security support. A sub-committee was announced to review and address security concerns. Despite acknowledging the security concerns, the ACS emphasized that they would prefer to implement the RIF – II Project within the given geographical locations of Bannu and D.I. Khan. However, he also assured that security concerns of the PIC will be addressed by the PMU and administration of both the districts. He also announced the formulation of a sub-committee for probing into PIC's security concerns and make adequate recommendations for reinforcing the same. The minutes of the meeting with ACS are attached as Annex 1.

3.4. Sub-Committee Meeting

The previously mentioned sub-committee was notified on 14 July 2025. The notification spells out the composition and a brief six points ToRs, all revolving around the security aspects. A copy of this notification is attached as Annex 2. The first meeting of the sub-committee was held at P&DD Peshawar on 21 July 2025, which was chaired by Executive Director (ED) UPPU, Mr Imad Ali Sahib. The PIC was represented by the Team Lead Mr Ayaz Khan and the Security Manager, Mr. Arif Khan. The meeting was also joined virtually by the representatives of KfW Ms. Lena Pohl Mr. Imran Khan and the PIC Project Director Mr. Ulrich Sammet and Ms. Julia Schaef.

After initial civilities and the brief presentation by the PD Mr. Saleh, the agenda points came under discussion. However, the main focus was the required engagement of the CSO. The Chair announced that due to urgency of the subject, instead of the fortnight, the next meeting will be held after 10 days. The PIC proposed that future meetings would be held within the project corridor which was agreed on by the Chair.

3.5. Physical Assessment and Site Verification Visits

Field visits for Physical Assessments were successfully conducted in February 2025, covering both the districts of Bannu and D.I. Khan. During these surveys, the national experts reconnoitered all the three core areas of RIF – II Project, which are being described further. The community infrastructure schemes as per the Project TORs are:

- Water Supply
- Wastewater Conveyance and Treatment
- Solid Waste Management

The report containing two volumes Water Supply and Wastewater Management (Sanitation) Report and the Solid Waste Management Report are under final internal revision with the corresponding experts of the PIC and will be submitted in the first week of September. A brief outline of the main aspect of the reports were provided in the previous quarterly progress report (3).

3.6. Social Actors Profile and Mapping

A comprehensive exercise was carried out in four accessible tehsils (Paharpur, Paroa, Domel, and Kakki) to identify male and female community activists and community leaders. Local informants and the female social mobilizer (PIC Expert Field Enumerator Ms. Rehana Shahid) and Coordinator and Social Mobilization Expert Mr. Nasrullah Khan, were engaged to ensure culturally appropriate outreach. Identified activists were approached to identify their later role and participation in workshops, where they were briefed on their voluntary roles. At the end of this fieldwork in all the four tehsils, the identified male and female activists were invited for a small workshop. They were given a structured briefing, which was participated in an active and enthusiastic manner. They were categorically informed that it would be a voluntary contribution without any remunerations. Photo-documentations of all the four workshops is attached as Annex 3.

3.7. Stakeholders Engagement Plan

A structured plan has been developed and drafted to ensure systematic and inclusive stakeholder participation at all stages of the project. It emphasizes participatory methods, local ownership, accountability, and transparency. It fosters participatory techniques and inclusive practices to enhance results and bolster accountability. Special attention is given to women's inclusion, using culturally sensitive approaches to ensure equitable participation in decision-making and service delivery. In the inception phase, prioritizing early and inclusive stakeholder

engagement is crucial. It aims at creating a sense of ownership of the RIF-II project and to ensure that the project aligns with the locals' needs. The stakeholders get involved from the outset which enhances the project's relevance, legitimacy, and long-term viability. The active participation of users persists throughout the implementation phase. It also aids in sustaining public trust and delivering services transparently and inclusively. The draft is attached in Annex 4

3.8. Peace and Conflict Assessment (PCA)

The PCA was drafted by the Security Manager and the Team Leader of the PIC team in order to assess the underlying conflicts in the project region and to help identify and mitigate risks related to the project implementation. Every community has its own working dynamics, which may trigger inter/intra-community communication impediments. Such matters may get initiated due to cast/tribal systems, ethnic divisions, political polarity, petty social frictions or mohalla based rivalries etc. Such occurrences may become detrimental for the Project, particularly at the execution stage. Hence, during the course of social actors' profiling and mapping, the PIC also made concerted efforts for assessing any potential conflict sensitivities in all the four workable of tehsils both the districts. The assessment outlines the historical and regional contest as well as the role of the RIF-II project in relation to peace and in the light of the "Do no Harm" approach. It highlights the importance of institutional reforms and strengthening local governance to build citizen-state trust

The PCA was submitted to KfW and the PMU and the received comments are currently under revision. The revised version will be submitted within September.

3.9. TORs for Civil Society Organization

The CSO TORs had already been shared with the PMU and KfW. Both the institutions had made some comments, which had duly been addressed by the IC, and DI management had resubmitted the document to PMU and KfW. It is expected that the CSO TORs will be approved within the due course. After a careful review, KfW had approved the draft CSO TORs, which have already been shared with all the stakeholders.

3.10. Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E)

3.10.1. M&E Framework

Based on result matrix, initial M&E framework has been completed. It covers the entire M&E component for all project phases, from inception till the final completion. Since the M&E framework is based on the result matrix, it will be updated further based on review of the result matrix indicators in the planning phase. As per technical proposal, result matrix indicators will be reviewed by the end of inception phase and during planning phase, based on findings of the baseline survey. Moreover, during the planning phase consultation will be held with CSO and community representatives to include the participatory M&E system. By the end of inception phase, it is expected that the CSO will be on board, and their input will be incorporated in the M&E frame. Therefore, till the planning phase the M&E framework will be a living document.

3.10.2. Work Breakdown Structure (WBS)

A WBS was developed based on the project planning document. In this system, the main project activities have further been bifurcated into sub-activities and tasks, which had also connected to each output. This document is usually developed during the planning phase, but the consultant team developed it based on RRM experience to scale up the project progress. Nevertheless, the WBS will be updated during the planning phase to align with any change

that may happen in the project plan.

3.10.3. Progress Tracking Sheet

A draft tracking sheet has also been developed, which will be used to track the planned activities in the WBS throughout the project life. It is also required to automate the quantitative project progress. Currently, the team is working on transforming the WBS into the MIS. The tracking sheet will also be updated in the planning phase along with review of the result matrix and changes in the project planned activities.

3.10.4. M&E Formats

The M&E formats are usually developed during the planning phase. But during inception phase monitoring formats for meetings, workshops as well as for sectoral monitoring, such as water supply, wastewater and solid waste components have been developed by using the RRM experience. In the planning phase additional monitoring formats will also be developed for different activities as and when the final plan and designs of various activities will be finalized.

3.10.5. Data Collection Mechanism

The data collection mechanism of the project is drafted and currently it is being developed further. This entails the data collection against project outputs, activities and sub activities in order to feed it into the result matrix indicator in a logical sequence. Since it is a large and widely scattered project, the data collection mechanism is complex and multifaceted and will go over the entire planning phase.

3.11. Management Information System (MIS)

The MIS application continues to enhance its capabilities and user experience through several key features designed to support data visualization, real-time updates, and comprehensive activity tracking across multiple administrative regions, including support for the RIF – II initiatives.

3.11.1. Key Features & Functionalities

a. Dashboard Section:

The MIS dashboard includes interactive GIS maps covering the two districts of DI Khan and Bannu. Users can explore the districts, tehsils, and NCs, and the related layers of project activities with detailed geographic insights. Maps are downloadable as JPG images for offline use. Additionally, a photo gallery with a slideshow and hover-over details (event name, date, category) provides a visual narrative of activities. Three summary graphs display overall output percentages, district-wise and sector-wise progress, offering quick performance insights. The dashboard also integrates a quick links menu and a scrolling news bar to keep users informed of real-time updates.

b. Activity Progress Tracking:

The system allows viewers and users to filter activity data by output, main activity, sub-activity, district, tehsil, and sector. This filtered data can be exported in PDF or excel formats to facilitate reporting and analysis. Editor users have enhanced permissions to add, edit, and update tracking data and progress indicators, ensuring the MIS database remains current and accurate.

c. Documents and Reports Management:

Users can view, filter (by name, type, and date), and download official documents and reports.

This streamlined access supports transparency and documentation integrity within the department.

d. **Important Links Section:**

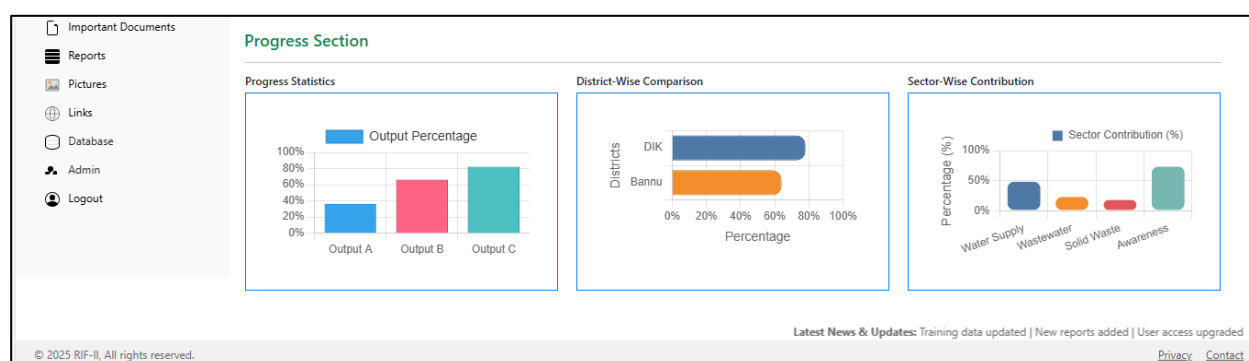
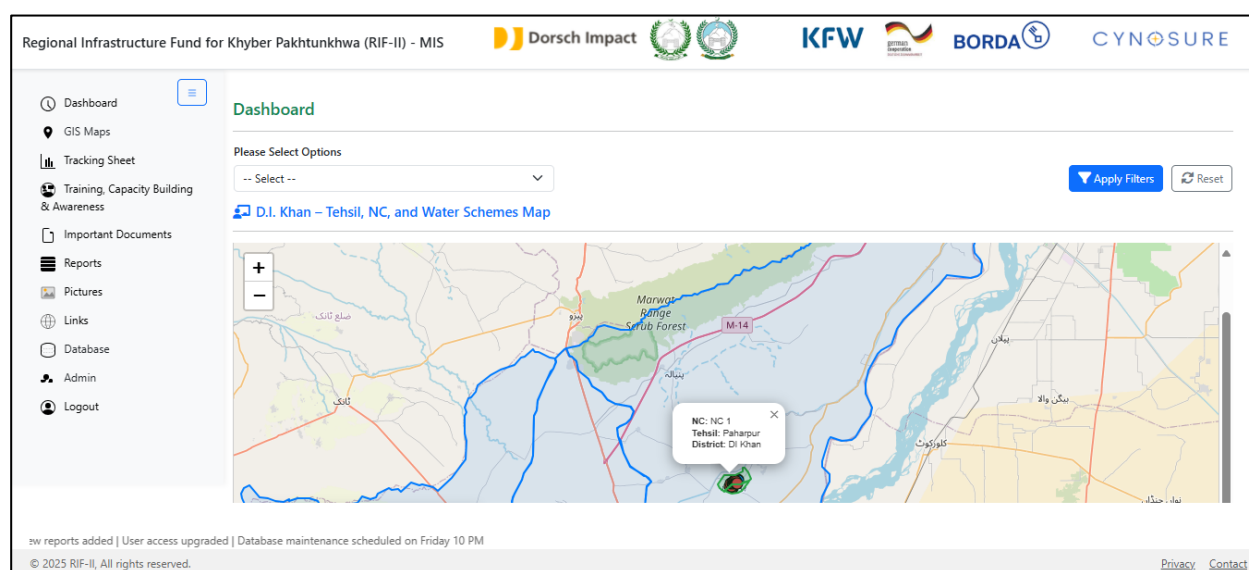
A centralized repository of key office-related links enables quick access and download of essential resources, enhancing operational efficiency.

e. **User Access Control:**

The MIS enforces a clear delineation and separation of roles and responsibilities:

- **Editor Users:** Hold exclusive rights to manage data, including adding, editing, updating, and deleting records across all modules. A dedicated editor-only menu facilitates these functions.
- **General Users:** Are limited to content viewing, maintaining data security and integrity.

The MIS system has made significant strides in improving usability, data visualization, and access control. The introduction of interactive GIS maps and graphical summary of aids in better monitoring and decision-making. Role-based access ensures data quality and security, while export capabilities support diverse reporting needs. Overall, the MIS continues to serve as a vital tool in tracking and managing departmental activities efficiently, with ongoing support for RIF – II project.



3.12. PMU Relates Aspects

An on-going liaison and coordination with PMU had been a routine feature throughout the reported period. In this period, physical contacts with PMU and P&DD had been made on the following occasions:

- 5 – 7 May 2025: PD's visit to DI Khan and Bannu, and meetings with both the district administrations.
- 30 June 2025: Meeting with ACS at P&DD Peshawar in context with security scenario of the project corridor. ACS was also given a briefing about the RIF – II progress.
- 21 July 2025: For attending the meeting of Sub-Committee at P&DD Peshawar. It was formulated by ACS for deliberating about security aspects of RIF – II and for proposing the adequate mitigation measures.

During last week of the quarter under report, PD RIF – II, Mr. Muhammad Saleh, had been posted out to another department. GoKP's notification of his transfer order is attached as Annex 5. During Mr. Saleh's tenure of six months, he strived extra hard for establishing the PMU, staff recruitment, procurements, bank accounts and many more. The PIC developed a constructive working relationship with him, which is considered essential for the project's success. His premature departure raises concerns about continuity and sustainability. A replacement has yet to be announced.

3.13. Project Transport

In April 2025, the PIC procured a Toyota Corolla. A second Toyota Corolla car is also being arranged. In addition to the two soft cars, a bulletproof Toyota Landcruiser is equally planned for the visiting international experts but delayed due to incomplete formalities and pending NOC from the federal government.

However, during recent times, PMU has been approached for arranging the NOC from the Federal Government, Ministry of Interior, for the procurement of bulletproof vehicle. Under an interim arrangement, the PIC have been reliant on locally hired transport services. However, given the prevailing security conditions, only trusted and vetted drivers can be engaged, further constraining mobility and operational efficiency³.

A copy of the letter requesting NOC for the bulletproof vehicle is attached as Annex 6.

³ Some incidents of kidnappings have been reported by travelling in the unknown and untrustworthy local transport.

4. Financial Information

4.1. Consultancy Budget

Table 6: Consultancy Budget

Description	Invoice Number	Date of Invoice	Date of Payment	Total payment received until 31.07.2025
Quarterly payments				
Advance payment	7.01.4948 / 1	30.10.2024	27.11.2024	648 199.35
Quarterly instalment	7.01.4948 / 2	27.11.2024	03.12.2024	74 308.50
Quarterly instalment	P1127.00/1	05.02.2025	20.02.2025	79 842.00
Quarterly instalment	P1127.00/3	12.06.2025	01.07.2025	121 527.53
Total Lump sum payments				923 877.38
Reimbursable payments				
Reimbursable 1	P1127.00/2 reimbursable 1	05.02.2025	20.02.2025	30 198. 35
Reimbursable 2	P1127.00/4 reimbursable 2	12.06.2025	01.07.2025	26 326. 50
Total Reimbursable payments				56 524.85
Reimbursable (still open)				328 475.15

4.2. Reimbursables

Table 7: Reimbursables

Summary of Expenses - Reimbursable spent during the period (August 2024 – July 2025)					
Budget line	Description	Original Budget EUR	Budget Spent in PKR	Budget Spent in EUR	Balance EUR
Budget 8.1.	Office equipment	35 000.00	6 785 149.00	23 866.26	11 133.74
Budget 8.2.	Bullet proof	100 000.00	0.00	0.00	100 000.00
Budget 8.3.	Project vehicles	70 000.00	5 792 389.00	18 382.01	51 617.99
Budget 9.1.	Security measures incl. personnel, equipment etc.	150 000.00	2 095 370.00	19 829.61	130 170.39
Budget 9.2.	Remote MIS	20 000.00	0.00	0.00	20 000.00
Budget 9.3.	Workshop	5 000.00	485 378.00	1 542.97	3 457.03
Budget 9.4.	Baseline	5 000.00	0.00	0.00	5.000.00
Total		385 000.00	15 158 286.00	63 620.85	321 379.15

4.3. Disposition Fund

The Disposition Fund is active as of 16.05.2025.

Table 8: Disposition Fund

	Description	Budget (EUR)	Expenditures (EUR)	Remaining (EUR)
Budget line 1.	Investment cost for realization of Output 1 (construction of infrastructure) in Bannu and D.I. Khan including construction/civil works, capacity enhancement, and contracting CBO.	12 278 987.00	0.00	12 278 987.00
Budget line 2.	Salaries for up to three expert positions for project management unit at the Urban Policy Unit (UPU)	371 013.00	9 261.63	361 751.37
Budget line 3.	Contingencies, incl. external audits	500 000.00	0.00	500 000.00
Budget line	Bank Fee	0.00	402.93	-402.93
Total		13 150 000.00	0.00	13 140 335.44

4.4. Disbursement and Procurement

No disbursement and procurement have been executed in this reporting period.

Table 9: Overall Disbursement by the end of the reporting period

Summary of Disbursements (August 2024 – April 2025) Invoiced to KfW					
Budget line	Description	Original Budget EUR	Budget Spent in PKR	Budget Spent in EUR	Balance EUR
None yet					
Total					

The forecast of disbursements for the next reporting period(s), including estimated timing and amounts of disbursement requests, as well as a preview of the payment schedule until the end of the project.

Table 10: Forecast of Disbursements

Summary of Disbursements (April – July 2025) Invoiced to KfW					
Budget line	Description	Original Budget EUR	Planned Budget in EUR (forecast)	Spent in EUR	The total balance on the account on 31.07.2025
1	Investment cost for realization of Output 1 (construction of infrastructure) in Bannu and D.I. Khan including construction/civil works, capacity enhancement, and contracting CBO.	12 278 987.00	0.00	0.00	
2	Salaries for up to three expert positions for project management unit at the Urban Policy Unit (UPU)	371 013.00	25 313.85	9 261.63	
3	Contingencies, incl. external audits	500 000.00	158 000.00	0.00	
	Bank fee	0.00	200.00	152,93	
Total		13 150 000.00	183 513.85	9 414.56	174 099.29

The table below outlines the total volume, remaining funds, state of disbursements, and required funds for the next reporting period.

Table 11: Forecast of Finances

Description	Amount EUR
Total Project Volume	21 000 000
Amount of Consulting Contract	4 321 329
Invoiced Amount	980 402.23
Disbursement	
Total Disbursed	0
Remaining Funds	174 099.29
Forecast	
Required for Next Period	Next forecast to be submitted end of August by financial expert to UPPU

5. ESHS Performance

Due to a number of constraints, impediments, hurdles and other difficulties, no progress has been made on this important aspect of Environmental, Social, Health and Safety (ESHS). As per inception phase work plan, this activity will be undertaken after having completed the physical assessment, identification and prioritization of schemes.

In February 2025 the physical assessment and site verification study had been conducted in both the districts by the national consultants. Fieldwork had been completed well before onset of Ramadan. However, the internationals could not be mobilized due to security sensitivities, as the NOC was not issued by the GoKP. The first draft of the report had been received by the PIC in the beginning of April 2025. It necessitated some professional comments, which had been made and the report referred to the originators. After due corrections, the report had been shared with the respective internationals. Their comments, professional assessment and views are awaited.

After finalization of physical assessment and site verification report, the next major exercise is prioritization of infrastructural schemes. It will be done in a collaborative and integrated manner, involving all the stakeholders, including the beneficiaries. It is only at this stage that ESHS team will be mobilized to perform their role, well before the construction work execution.

At this stage the PIC have already commenced their work for mobilising the stakeholders and the respective communities for initiating the infrastructural schemes selection process in all the four accessible tehsils.

For saving time, PIC have generated a parallel activity of pre-mobilization of the ESHS experts. They have been contacted and forewarned for their deployment.

6. Quality Management

The Consultants and their partners are conscious of applying a process-oriented quality management system characterized by standardized processes, that will serve as a universal guide throughout all project phases, ensuring the delivery of results and outcomes as outlined in the Technical Proposal. Additionally, it provides appropriate home office support and backstopping while addressing emerging challenges in a timely, professional, and suitable manner.

We consider the performance of our experts, transparent information flow, efficient utilization of the project budget, and adequate security measures as critical factors for the successful Project implementation.

However, quality management aspects are more relevant to the design and physical implementation stage of the Project. Hence, as yet not much has been contributed to quality management.

7. Challenges

7.1. Security Situation

The project corridor experienced a notable escalation in militant activity during the quarter. Key trends included:

- Rising militant casualties (from 56 in May to 154 in July).
- Increased arrests in June, reflecting intelligence-based operations.
- Greater reliance on kinetic engagements in July.
- Intensification of Improvised Explosive Devices (IED) use, targeted killings, abductions, and fire raids, particularly in urban and border fringe zones.

Civilians, especially in Bannu, were heavily affected, while extortion remained persistent but under-reported.

During the course of social actors' profile mapping, in mid-May 2025 the PIC faced some security related impediments at Paniala, a sub-tehsil of Paharpur. A few days prior to the planned visit of PIC Experts to Paniala, a few cases of abductions and kidnappings had been reported. Upon the strict advise of Security Manager, the visit was postponed. Being the first case of this nature from the project corridor, it created a serious alarm, which was reported to the management of Dorsch Impact (DI). Paharpur Tehsil is known to be the most peaceful sub-division of DI Khan District. This was the first such incident in the corridor, raising significant concern. A detailed incident-based security report for the quarter is attached as Annex 7.

The PIC subsequently informed GoKP and KfW through an official letter about the increasing security concerns hindering the implementation of project activities (letters dated 3 and 27 June 2025, attached as Annex 8).

7.2. Road Travel Conditions

The road travel conditions during the reporting quarter, did not display any improvements. Rather, some deterioration has been reported. The general travel conditions along the 100 km stretch of the M-14 (Islamabad–D.I. Khan Motorway) in KP equally did not display any improvements. While “no-go” designations have not been reinstated, sporadic incidents—including abductions and gunfire—continue to pose safety risks. Caution is advised when traveling this route. A vast majority of government officials refrain from travelling on this segment of the motorway. They prefer to undertake a longer, but safer route via Chashma Barrage and Mianwali.

Access to several side roads—particularly those leading to **Tank, Kulachi, Daraban, and Darazinda**—remains restricted, with dusk-to-dawn travel curfews enforced in multiple areas. These measures are largely in response to ongoing militant reprisals against security operations.

7.3. On-going Military Operations

A broad intelligence-led counterinsurgency campaign remains active in North and South Waziristan, including five tehsils deemed inaccessible within the project corridor. In retaliation, militant groups have escalated their attacks, maximum focus being on the much talked Miryan Tehsil of Bannu. In July 2025, Miryan came under nine attacks, two fire raids and seven quadcopter attacks with payload of explosives.

The project corridor has seen a surge in abductions and kidnappings, particularly in **Tank**, now considered the most high-risk zone for such incidents. This has created a climate of fear and

uncertainty, undermining both public morale and operational logistics.

Militant tactics have evolved to include:

- Frequent targeting of soft civilian infrastructure such as schools, hospitals, and public transit areas,
- Deliberate attempts to terrorize local populations to facilitate militant mobility and influence.
- For inculcating a higher degree of fear amongst the masses, off-late, even the young male and female children have also been brutally murdered in front of their parents.

7.4. Political Influences

D.I. Khan continues to experience heightened political activity and volatility. The district is uniquely complex, serving as the constituency of both the Governor and Chief Minister of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, who represent rival political parties⁴. It is also home to a prominent figure from a major politico-religious party.

This overlapping political influence has fragmented local society and created a tense environment where rallies, sit-ins, and even armed skirmishes are frequent.

During field operations, project teams have encountered politically affiliated groups, some of which have attempted to align themselves with the project for electoral leverage. In certain instances, the team was compelled to clarify the project's apolitical and development-focused mandate to avoid entanglement in local politics.

The politicization of project visibility poses a significant risk to operational neutrality and public perception.

⁴ Fazal-ur-Rehman is a politician and cleric who is the president of Jamiat Ulema-e-Islam. He was previously the president of the Pakistan Democratic Movement, a coalition of political parties which ousted then prime minister Imran Khan through a no-confidence motion in 2022.

8. Risk Assessment and Prospect of Achieving the Overall Project Goals

A revised and updated risk assessment matrix, displaying the basic ranking at the time of bidding and the current status as per ground realities, is presented below. It gives a risk ranking vis-à-vis the potential threat, proposed mitigation measures and the post-mitigation scenario of threats.

Event	Risk Ranking		Mitigation Measures	Risk after Mitigation	Remarks
	Original	Current			
Denied access to specific Project locations due to security reasons.	High	Very High	- Constant vigilance. - Close liaison with civil/military officials, RMO, and on-site tehsil administration. - Processing all the legal required documentation (NOC) proactively prior to site visits.	Very High	During recent times, security has gone from bad to worst. Exodus of locals has increased. No immediate signs of any settlements.
Kidnap for ransom or political purposes.	Medium	Very High	- Secure accommodation and office. - Site- specific security assessment. - Presence of security guards. - Avoiding night travel. - Proactive communication with stakeholders and administration officials.	Very High	Kidnappings for ransom have drastically increased. Cases have been reported in the broad day-light from motorway section within the KP. Perhaps, it has become the major source of funds generation by the militants.
Improvised explosive device (IED) near to travel route or workplace, either vehicle borne or planted.	High	Very High	- Secure accommodation and office. - Usage of security equipment, razor wire fence and CCTV system. - Expats must use armoured vehicles and escort. - Adhering to district police and RMO's advice	Very High	Increased insurgency has proportionately brought a higher surge in IEDs cases, resulting in considerable number of damages and deaths.
Sectarian violence and tribal dispute	High	High	- Proactive site assessment. - Communication with local authorities and community people. - Avoid areas of dispute. - Stay neutral during community meetings. - Avoid political and religious discussions. - Secure accommodation and office.	Medium	In DI Khan three tehsils are known for a varying degree of sectarian violences, i.e. DI Khan, Paharpur and Parova. <i>Shia – Sunni</i> rift is a simmering issue for the past nearly three decades.
Small firearms.	Medium	Medium	- Secure accommodation and office. - Armoured vehicles for expats.	Medium	Pathan population is known for being trigger happy. Firing is also done at occasions of happiness, like marriages. At occasions, stray bullets have also caused deaths.

Event	Risk Ranking		Mitigation Measures	Risk after Mitigation	Remarks
	Original	Current			
Thefts.	Medium	Medium	- Secure accommodation and office. - Adhering to district police. - RMO advice.	Medium	DI Khan has become an undeclared IDPs camp. Theft cases have increased due to new in-migrants from unsettled areas of militancy.
Natural disasters – flash rain storms and subsequent floodings and landslides, wind/dust storms, and earthquakes, etc.	Medium	Medium	- Check forecasts from Pakistan Meteorological Department and the National Disaster Management Authority website. - Stay indoor during wind storms. - Check news reports. - Be aware of the risk of road blockages, particularly in mountainous regions.	Medium	Project corridor is located in sub-tropical sandy desert, Thal, which is known for ferocious summer wind storms. It may cause severe damages.
COVID-19 & Infections; injury or disease from environmental contamination	Low	Medium	- Personal hygiene. - All the precautionary measures. - Wearing face masks all the time. - Social distancing. - Washing hands, using hand sanitizers etc. - In case of doubts, COVID-19 infection tests. - Vaccinations.	Medium	Due to poor sanitation, there are a lot of water ponds. Hence, reemergence of COVID-19 infection, malaria and/or dengue fever cannot be ruled out.
Political Risks					
Governmental Instability: Sudden changes in political leadership or administrative priorities may delay the project.	High	Very High	Stakeholder Engagement: - Build strong relationships with both local and central government representatives, tribal elders, and political actors from the outset. - Establish a local advisory committee for inclusive decision-making.	Very High	Being from opponent parties, provincial government is having a perpetual friction with the federal government, which raises questions about its stability.
Parties, Policy Reversal: New government may revoke or amend agreements or laws under which the project was initiated.	High	Very High	Legal and Regulatory Clarity: - Secure formal agreements or MoUs that clearly define project scope, ownership, and responsibilities. - Regularly review and align with evolving local and national regulations.	Very High	There are chances that new GokP may change geographical location of the project.

Event	Risk Ranking		Mitigation Measures	Risk after Mitigation	Remarks
	Original	Current			
Interference by Local Power Brokers: Local political actors or tribal elites may exert pressure for control over hiring, procurement, or project direction.	High	Very High	Flexible Project Design: - Design activities in phases to allow course correction based on political developments. - Include contingency funds and alternate plans in case of disruption.	Very High	Owing to political polarisation, there are all the chances of some interference and political pressures.
Security Policy Shifts: Military or paramilitary operations may restrict access or lead to forced project suspensions.	High	Very High	Security and Risk Monitoring: - Establish a dedicated risk and security monitoring team to provide early warnings. - Maintain coordination with local security forces and humanitarian access agencies.	Very High	Due to hyper-security sensitivities, RIF – II may come under some pressures, which cannot be foreseen at this stage.
Management Risks					
Inadequate HR Capacity: Project staff may lack technical skills or local experience.	Low	Low	Capacity Building and Training: - Provide regular training and mentoring to project staff. - Hire local professionals where feasible to improve contextual understanding and retention.	Low	IC hired seasoned / experienced staff with adequate experience, skills and local experience.
Poor Planning and Oversight: Weak coordination, unrealistic timelines, or failure to adapt to field realities.	Low	Low	Robust Project Management Tools: - Use project management software for planning, tracking, and reporting. - Develop clear work plans, MIS and M&E frameworks.	Low	Uncertainties due to security sensitivities lead to travel restrictions and field visits, causing cascading chain of multiple delays.
Financial Mismanagement: Budget overruns, delayed disbursements, or funds misallocation.	Low	Low	Financial Controls and Audits: - Establish transparent financial procedures, including dual signatories and procurement oversight. - Conduct regular internal and external audits.	Low	Stringent financial controls are well embedded, including external audits.
High Staff Turnover: Frequent changes in key personnel disrupting project continuity and institutional memory.	Low	Low	Staff Retention Strategies: - Offer competitive compensation, incentives, and growth opportunities. - Create a strong organizational culture and clear career development paths.	Medium	Minimal chances of staff turnover. However, security threats may trigger such eventualities.

Event	Risk Ranking		Mitigation Measures	Risk after Mitigation	Remarks
	Original	Current			
Fiduciary Risks:					
Misuse of Funds: Project funds diverted for personal use or non-project activities.	Low	Low	Strong Financial Management Systems: - Implement automated accounting software with real-time tracking. - Ensure segregation of duties in financial operations.	Low	Minimal chances due to tried and tested financial management controls.
Procurement Irregularities: Non-transparent bidding, favoritism, or collusion in contractor selection.	Low	Low	Transparent Procurement Processes: - Follow donor or government-approved procurement guidelines. - Publicly disclose bidding results and evaluation criteria.	Low	Transparent, open and competitive bidding system will minimize any chances of irregularities.
Lack of Financial Transparency: Inadequate financial reporting, delayed audits, or false accounting.	Low	Low	Regular Auditing and Reporting: - Conduct periodic internal and external audits. - Submit timely, standardized financial reports to stakeholders.	Low	Due to well embedded procedures, period audits and checks and balances, financial systems are very transparent.
Weak Internal Controls: Absence of proper checks and balances in financial transactions and asset management.	Low	Low	Capacity Building and Ethical Oversight: - Train staff in financial integrity and anti-corruption measures. - Establish a whistleblower policy and independent grievance mechanism.	Low	Due to strong and time-tested internal procedures, financial controls are very stringent and transparent.

9. Outlook and Recommendations

Towards the end of the quarter, the PIC reviewed completed, ongoing, and pending activities and prepared an revised project plan. This includes priority trainings, stakeholder capacity building, procurement of simple tools (PPEs etc.), community engagement initiatives and quick-win small infrastructure projects. Subject to security conditions, these will be undertaken in the next quarters (August–October 2025 and furtehr).

9.1. Mapping and Selection of Community Infrastructural Schemes

The infrastructural schemes for project interventions will be selected in collaboration with the identified community representatives, the TMA, the PHED and other key stakeholders, including verifications of the existing hotspots. Additionally, locations for potential new water supply, sanitation and solid waste management (SWM) facilities (including those requiring rehabilitation) will be identified and marked on the base maps. The process will consist of the following steps:

- The base maps will be printed on A1-size sheets and used during the workshop sessions to mark selected locations for water supply, wastewater, and solid waste management facilities. Stakeholders will actively participate in the identification of hotspot areas/ sites and to identify sites suitable for quick-win interventions.
- In coordination with the sector and GPS experts, the verified coordinates will be collected, and the GIS team will update the base maps accordingly.

The situation maps will be created based on the inputs form the physical assessment and the mapping workshops by the GIS Expert. The maps will visualize the information collected during the mapping workshop of identified potential schemes and other relevant points of interest.

Identification and detailed planning of 1-2 small-scale, high-impact pilot infrastructure schemes per tehsil, demonstrating tangible quick benefits, will be the focus and the list will contain a ranking of urgency, implement ability and effectiveness.

Immediately following these workshops, a detailed list of proposed schemes will be compiled. Given the importance of community and stakeholder consultation in the planning process, project selection discussions will be held as part of the mapping workshops (in adjusted format) to ensure that high-impact pilot infrastructure projects are identified collaboratively.

- Experts site visits with stakeholders.
- On site discussions with representatives (if possible, depending on security of site)

Information from mapping workshops and the creation of a list of interventions and possible options, prioritization workshops will be held together with representatives from the communities and other relevant stakeholders form the district/tehsil officials to jointly discuss the potential options and rank them based on necessity, implement-ability and impact for the local users.

9.2. Implementation of Quick Win Activities

For gaining the confidence of respective communities, end users, all the stakeholders and for establishing a bond of mutual trust and confidence, few quick-win interventions have been planned, which are explained further.

Direct award quotations for the procurement of personal protective equipment (PPE), which are meant for sanitary workers of all the TMAs. This small and inexpensive equipment will

contribute towards hygienic and safe working conditions. In addition, it can also make significant contributions towards visibility of the RIF – II Project. Once procured, it will be distributed after holding a one-day practical training of sanitary workers.

Rapid needs assessment with TMAs offers a practical quick win. Items such as wheelbarrows, waste trolleys, drain cleaning rods, and PPEs can be quickly procured to address critical service gaps. This intervention will immediately enhance waste collection and drain clearance operations, particularly in high-risk urban areas, improving public hygiene and municipal service delivery system.

Identification of quick-win sites will take place together with TMAs, NCs and informed by the findings of the physical assessment. Such sites of quick intervention are likely to comprise upon the followings:

- Rehabilitation of existing handpumps and boreholes:
- Installation of community water storage tanks at schools or mosques etc.
- Household rainwater harvesting systems, drums or filters for roof collection.
- Replacement of damaged water pipes in high-loss zones.
- Targeted leak repairs with minimal excavation.
- Chlorination points at source tanks: Ensures water safety without major infrastructure.
- Rehabilitation of small local collection points, wheelie bins to organized groups (e.g., schools/shops).
- Support to informal waste workers (PPEs and carts etc).
- Upgrading communal latrines (especially in schools/markets).

9.3. Trainings

A variety of trainings for different stratifications have also been proposed for varying audiences. This activity will also give quick results and enhance the project visibility. Such trainings are being explained further.

9.3.1. Security Protocol Training

Security-focused training will be delivered to PIC Experts and later considered to be upscaled to other relevant stakeholders of the local government. Sessions will cover safety procedures and risk mitigation. To reduce exposure, most trainings will be held in secure venues (D.I. Khan, Bannu, or, if required, Islamabad/Peshawar).

9.3.2. Community Trainings – Religious Leaders (*Imams*)

In a conservative society, having religious orientation, mosque *imams* play a very crucial, critical and important role. Their voice is very powerful, and their instructions are being cared and carried forward. It may also be pointed out that Quran and Sunnah make a very elaborate coverage about water conservation, water quality, hygiene and sanitation.

Hence, in this training workshop, mosque *imams* will be briefed about the three core project activities and shall be requested to inform their followers in the Friday sermons. Besides a general education, the beneficiary communities will be sensitized and mobilized in a very effective and economical manner.

9.3.3. Community Trainings – Civil Society Leaders

Like *imams*, a conservative society also pays a very respect to the elders. Their word of mouth carries a high respect and draws attention of all, alike. They will also be sensitized and

mobilized about water conservation, water quality, hygiene, sanitation and SWM.

Efforts will also be made for bringing the religious leaders and civil society leaders on one platform. This effort will strengthen their voices, which is likely to get reinforced and may create a more powerful impact for the benefits of all, alike.

9.3.4. Trainings on Waterborne Diseases

Owing to a general ignorance about waterborne diseases, this is a mandatory training across the board, including all segments, i.e. TMAs, PHED, NCs/VCs and the beneficiaries. It is commonly believed that water is the largest media for disease transmission. These diseases are primarily transmitted through water ingestion that contains pathogenic microorganisms such as bacteria, viruses, or parasites. Contamination often results from poor sanitation, inadequate sewage treatment, or unprotected water sources.

Common water-borne diseases include cholera, typhoid fever, dysentery, hepatitis A and E, and giardiasis. Symptoms typically involve diarrhoea, vomiting, fever, abdominal pain, and dehydration, and can be severe or even fatal, particularly among children, the elderly, and people with compromised immune systems.

It may also be pointed out that the basic service providers, i.e. TMAs and PHED, are equally unaware about the waterborne diseases. At a later stage, the same training will also be done for educational institutions.

9.3.5. Solid Waste Management Trainings

SWM and sanitation are the most neglected and the least cared sectors. Hardly any one realizes that neglect of these two sectors contribute a lot to spread this menace in the shape disease vector, environmental degradation and the general hygiene of the area. Hence, this training is also planned across the board, i.e. officials/staff of TMAs, PHED and community representatives. At a later stage, it can be extended further to educational and health institutions. Once the CSO is on board, its orbit can be enhanced further right down to HHs level, including the housewives, who are the basic solid waste generators. It generally pertains to the following topics:

- Staff and public sensitization to educate them for health and safety risks during operations.
- Importance and the use of PPEs.
- Training on waste minimization, generation and handling at source.
- To educate the elected members regarding their role in SWM and sensitization for participation in waste minimization, proper handling at source and collection process.
- General training on SWM systems.
- To educate the TMAs management and field staff regarding waste generation, collection, transportation, processing and safe final disposal.
- To educate the TMA staff and community on composting and biogas preparation and processing.

9.3.6. Community Representative Trainings

The community representatives are the elected male and female members of tehsil council, NCs and VCs. Their main training focus will be on the followings:

- **Gender Inclusion and Women's Leadership:** Build the leadership capacity of elected women representatives and other active women in communities in relation to the waste

management, sanitation and water supply etc.

- **Civic Education and Community Rights Training:** To raise awareness among community members about their roles, rights and responsibilities, how local governments work and how they can participate in decision-making. Training also explains the importance of accountability and transparency in service delivery.
- **Training on Grievance Redress and Feedback Mechanisms:** To help communities understand how to raise complaints and share feedback, explains the purpose of grievance systems and how they can improve service delivery, guides local institutions on how to respond effectively and fairly.
- **Community Training on Participatory Development:** To strengthen community participation in local development. It introduces the concept of participatory development in simple terms. Community members learn how to identify needs, set priorities, and plan collectively.
- **Larger Infrastructure Developments:** High-impact infrastructure projects are more realistically planned during the implementation phase, as the short four-month inception period does not allow sufficient time for the full execution of infrastructure activities. However, certain procurement-related initiatives can be delivered during the inception phase through direct award.

Bulk of such like trainings will be undertaken after hiring of CSO, which are likely to be pursued throughout the project life.

9.4. Procurement Plan

The revised Procurement Plan will be submitted to KfW for their review and issuance of a non-objection. Upon receiving this clearance:

- Equipment procurement for the PMU and broader project needs can commence.
- Equipment for quick win interventions

Annexes

Annex 1 MoM ACS

Annex 2 Sub-Committee Notification

Annex 3 Photo Documentation Social Actors Workshop

Annex 4 Stakeholder Engagement Plan

Annex 5 PD Transfer Notice

Annex 6 NOC Armoured SUV RIF-II

Annex 7 Detailed Security Report

Annex 8 Security Letter by Dorsch Impact and KfW Response Letter

Annex 1

MoM ACS Meeting



GOVERNMENT OF KHYBER PAKHTUNKHWA
PLANNING & DEVELOPMENT DEPARTMENT
URBAN POLICY & PLANNING UNIT

Email: upu@urbanpolicyunit.gkp.pk / Phone: +92-91-9212029

UPPU/Minutes/RRMIC/Project/2025-126/ 272-86

Dated Peshawar 04-07-2025

To

1. **The Secretary to the Govt. of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa**
 - i. LGE&RD Department
 - ii. Public Health Engineering Department
2. Chief RD, P&D Department
3. Chief IDS, P&D Department
4. Deputy Commissioner, D.I.Khan
5. Deputy Commissioner, Bannu
6. Project Director, RRMIC (Bannu & D.I.Khan), Peshawar
7. Mr. Imran Khan, Senior Sector Specialist, KfW, Islamabad
8. Mr. Ayaz Khan, Team Lead, Dorsch Impact (PIC), D.I.Khan
9. Mr. Arif Khan, Security Manager, Dorsch Impact (PIC), D.I.Khan

Subject: **MINUTES OF THE MEETING ON SECURITY ISSUES OF THE PROJECT
REGIONAL INFRA STRUCTURE FUND-II RRMIC (BANNU & D.I.KHAN).**

Dear Sir,

A meeting on the subject noted above was held on 30/06/2025, in the New Committee Room of P&DD, under the chairmanship of the worthy Additional Chief Secretary P&D Department.

Kindly find enclosed herewith a copy of the approved minutes of the captioned meeting for your information and further +necessary action at your end, please.


Sr. GIS Specialist
UPPU

Copy forwarded for favour of information to:

1. PSO to Chief Minister, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa
2. PSO to Chief Secretary, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa
3. PS to Additional Chief Secretary, P&DD
4. PS to Secretary P&DD
5. PS to Executive Director, UPPU


Sr. GIS Specialist
UPPU



**GOVERNMENT OF KHYBER PAKHTUNKHWA
PLANNING AND DEVELOPMENT DEPARTMENT
REGIONAL INFRASTRUCTURE FUND-II(RRMIC)**

9-A, Rehman Baba Road, University Town, Peshawar Phone No. 0915702645

3. Mr. Ayaz Khan, Team Lead from Dorsch Impact, provided a detailed overview of the project. He outlined significant challenges faced by the consultants due to law and order situation in the project areas, stating that 56% of the area is currently unreachable, leaving only 44% for field activities. He also informed the forum that due to these constraints the project activities are not progressing at the desired pace as outlined in work plan. He apprised the forum that taking cognizance of the security concerns, the Implementing Consultants had informed KfW through a letter dated **03 June 2025**, wherein the Project Implementation Consultant (PIC) referred to multiple security incidents in Bannu and D.I. Khan; due to which they suspended or rarely conducted field operations, restricted their traveling, leading to adjustment in geographical focus, implementation modalities, and timelines. The PIC also expressed concerns regarding the continuation of operations under such conditions. He further referred to the letter dated **27 June 2025**, addressed to the Worthy Additional Chief Secretary (P&DD), stating that the letter highlights suboptimal project progress, endorses the PIC's views regarding the volatile security situation in the project area and emphasized over the safety and sustainability of investments.

4. Mr. Arif Khan, Security Incharge of PIC elaborated in detail a comprehensive overview of the security landscape of the adjoining districts and submitted statistical data of target killings, abductions, extortions and improvised explosive device (IED) incidents cases in the region. He highlighted the frequency and occurrence of these incidents and linked it to delay in project implementation. This led to restricted mobility, limited field access, and increased operational risk for proposed project teams, having significant impact over timely execution of future planned activities in multiple sites.

5. Mr. Imran Khan, Senior Sector Specialist, KfW Islamabad, referred to the KfW mission visit to RRM Mansehra, and the meeting on 16th of April 2025 with PD and representatives of P&D. He recalled that 44% of the project area is accessible and the forum had agreed to adopt a **“start small, scale up”** approach, focusing on activities in the accessible tehsils (i.e. Paharpur, Paroa, Kakki, and Domel) initially for six months' time (i.e. April–October 2025). The PIC, in consultation with DICCs, will be assessing the security situation during the intervening period and to determine about continuation or to work on alternative solutions. A Project Steering Committee meeting which is planned in post-October 2025 shall review this assessment and decide the future direction of the RIF-II project.



GOVERNMENT OF KHYBER PAKHTUNKHWA
PLANNING AND DEVELOPMENT DEPARTMENT
REGIONAL INFRASTRUCTURE FUND-II(RRMIC)
9-A, Rehman Baba Road, University Town, Peshawar Phone No. 0915702645

**MINUTES OF THE MEETING TO DISCUSS THE SECURITY ISSUES OF THE
PROJECT REGIONAL INFRASTRUCTURE FUND-II RESILIENT RESOURCE
MANAGEMENT IN CITIES (RRMIC), BANNU & D.I.KHAN)**

The subject meeting was held under the chairmanship of Worthy Additional Chief Secretary, Planning and Development Department on **30th June 2025 at 1200 hours PST.** The following were in attendance.

1. Executive Director, Urban Policy & Planning Unit, P&DD.
2. Deputy Executive Director, Urban Policy & Planning Unit, P&DD.
3. Chief International Development Section, P&DD.
4. Chief Regional Development Section, P&DD.
5. Project Director RIF-II RRMIC, UPPU, P&DD.
6. Assistant Chief, International Development Section, P&DD.
7. Additional Deputy Commissioner Bannu, Govt of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (Via video link).
8. Lena Pohl, Portfolio Manager KfW Development Bank (Via video link from Germany).
9. Mr. Imran Khan, Senior Sector Specialist, KfW Islamabad, (Via video link).
10. Mr Syed Shobair, KfW (Via video link).
11. Aron Muller, KfW (Via video link).
12. Mr. Ayaz Khan Team Lead Implementation consultant.
13. Mr. Arif Khan, Security Manager, Implementation consultant.
14. Ms. Shandara Arbab, Asst.Urban Planner, RIF-II RRMIC, UPPU, P&DD.
15. Mr. Ahmad Farooq, RIF-II RRMIC, UPPU, P&DD.

2. Meeting started with recitation of versus from the Holy Quran, followed by a brief introduction of the participants. Thereafter the Executive Director, UPPU informed the forum about the salient features of the project and elaborated that the instant meeting is to discuss the security concerns in the project corridor and to successfully implement the project in Bannu and D.I.Khan. It was followed by a detailed briefing by the Implementing consultants and a presentation of PMU by the PD, RIF II.



GOVERNMENT OF KHYBER PAKHTUNKHWA
PLANNING AND DEVELOPMENT DEPARTMENT
REGIONAL INFRASTRUCTURE FUND-II(RRMIC)
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6. After attentively reviewing the arguments presented regarding the concerns of PIC, the Additional Chief Secretary, Planning & Development, emphasized over the need of developmental interventions and completion of activities like timely engagement of CSO's and recruitment of necessary human resource, which may not be delayed solely on account of security concerns. The ACS urged all stakeholders to explore and implement alternative approaches that would enable continuation of activities within the existing project corridor. Some of the major activities like community participation etc. may be conducted in other feasible areas. The Chief IDS recommended that the respective District Intelligence Coordination Committees (DICC's) be actively engaged to formulate localized security plans and to provide strategic guidance to facilitate safe implementation. It was further suggested that exposure of consultants in the field be minimized by employing other low-risk tools for data collection and monitoring purposes.

7. Decisions:

After detailed deliberations, the following decisions were made:

1. A sub-committee comprising of Chief IDS, UPPU, PIC and KfW shall be constituted to deliberate upon a way forward over PIC concerns and for the successful execution of project activities through alternative measures. The details of the meetings of the sub-committee to be outlined in the TORs.
2. The District Intelligence Coordination Committees (DICC's) Bannu & D.I.Khan shall be engaged to develop localized security plans and to provide strategic guidance to support implementation of projects' field activities.
3. Project Executing agency to actively monitor the project activities and ED UPPU to personally look after the PMU and PIC for future interventions as per agreement signed between the donor and the recipient.
4. A follow-up meeting of all the stakeholders shall be convened preferably with the Worthy Additional Chief Secretary, P&D, in a fortnight to deliberate on the recommendation of the sub-committee regarding operational road map.

The meeting ended with a mutual vote of thanks

Annex 2

Sub-Committee Notification

**GOVERNMENT OF
KHYBER PAKHTUNKHWA**
Planning and Development Department



INTERNATIONAL DEVELOPMENT SECTION

2nd Floor, New Block, P & D Department, Civil Secretariat, Peshawar, KP

Phone: +92 91 9210499 Fax: +92 91 9211369 Email: ids@pndkp.gov.pk

PndKPGovt

pndkpgovt

pndkp.gov.pk

Peshawar, Dated: 14th July, 2025

Notification No: C/IDS/P&D/KFW/2025/4057-61 The Competent Authority is pleased to constitute the Sub -Committee for the successful execution of project activities through alternative measures under the project titled: "Regional Infrastructure Fund- II RRMIC(Bannu & DI Khan)", with the following composition and TORs:

Composition of the Committee

1	Executive Director, Urban Policy Unit, P & DD.	Chair
2	Chief, International Development Section, P & DD	Member
3	Chief, Regional Development Section, P & DD	Member
4	Project Director, RIF II	Member/Secretary
5	Team Lead Dorsch Impact	Member
6	Any Co-opted Member, as required	Member

Terms of Reference (TORs):

- To deliberate on the concerns raised by the Project Implementation Consultant (PIC) and to explore viable alternative approaches for the successful execution of project activities.
- Review relevant documentation, consult stakeholders, and analyze the specific components affected by the raised concerns.
- Propose practical and compliant alternatives that ensure continuity and effectiveness in project delivery.
- Prepare a comprehensive report summarizing its findings, outlining proposed solutions, and presenting a clear action plan with timelines.
- Meetings will be conducted fortnightly.
- Any other agenda with approval of the chair.

----- sd -----
**SECRETARY, PLANNING &
DEVELOPMENT DEPARTMENT
KHYBER PAKHTUNKHWA**

Endst: No. & Date even.

Copy forwarded to the:

- All members of the Committee
- PS to Additional Chief Secretary, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa
- PS to Secretary, P&D Department Peshawar
- PS to Chief Economist, P&D Department, Peshawar

(DR.EHTISHAM UL HAQ)
Chief Int'l Development Section

Annex 3

Photo Documentation Social Actors Workshop

Annex – 5: Photo-Documentation of Social Actors Workshops



Photo - 1: Group discussion on project implementation. Paharpur, DI Khan



Photo - 2: Question answer session, Paharpur, DI Khan



Photo - 3: Watching the video of RRM Mansehra Project, Paharpur, DI Khan



Photo - 4: Group work for brainstorming of the participants, Paharpur, DI Khan



Photo - 5: Group work presented by team member, Paharpur, DI Khan



Photo - 6: Project introduction and objective of workshop, Paharpur, DI Khan



Photo - 7: Project orientation session to the activists-Paroa, DI Khan



Photo - 8: Briefing on the process of social actor identification, Paroa-DI Khan



Photo - 9: Group work for brainstorming of the participants, Paroa, DI Khan



Photo - 10: Getting inspiration from documentary of RRM Mansehra, Paroa, DI Khan



Photo - 11: Group work presented by team member, Paroa, DI Khan



Photo - 12: Project orientation session to the participants, Paniala, DI Khan



Photo - 13: Session on process for social actor profiling, Paniala, DI Khan



Photo - 14: Guidance provided to participants during group work, Paniala, DI Khan



Photo - 15: Group work presentation, Paniala, DI Khan



Photo - 16: RIF-II project orientation to the activists, Domel, Bannu



Photo - 17: Watching the documentary of RRM Mansehra Project, Domel, Bannu



Photo - 18: Collaborative group work for idea sharing, Domel, Bannu



Photo - 19: Presentation of group work by a team member – Domel, Bannu



Photo - 20: Orientation session on RIF-II project for activists, Kakki, Bannu



Photo - 21: Group work for brainstorming of the participants, Kakki, Bannu



Photo - 22: Team Member Presentation on Group Work, Kakki, Bannu

Annex 4

Stakeholder Engagement Plan

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List of abbreviations

CBO	Community Based Organization
CO	Community Organization
CSO	Civil Society Organization
FDG	Focus Group Discussions
GOVT	Government
GRM	Grievance Redress Mechanism
KP	Khyber Pakhtunkhwa
LGRDD	Local Government & Rural Development Department
NC	Neighborhood Council
NGO	Non-Government Organization
O&M	Operation and Maintenance
PHED	Public Health Engineering Department
PRA	Participatory Rural Appraisal
RIF-II	Reginal infrastructure Fund II
SEF	Stakeholder Engagement Framework
SWM	Solid Waste Management
TMA	Tehsil Muncipal Administration
VC	Village Council
VO	Village Organization
WASH	Water, Sanitation, and Hygiene

1. Introduction

This Stakeholder Engagement Framework (SEF) presents a clear, structured, and inclusive plan to involve all relevant stakeholders in the RIF-II Project. It applies throughout the entire project duration from the initial planning phase to final completion. The framework is built on lessons learned during the project's inception phase. It also incorporates findings and recommendations from institutional assessments conducted in the target areas. Additionally, it aligns with the Terms of Reference (ToR) for awareness-raising and outreach activities in Bannu and Dera Ismail Khan (DI Khan).

SEF in RIF-II is neither limited to a single stage nor a one-time event. It is a continuous, evolving, and flexible process that adapts over time. The framework allows for changes based on emerging needs, stakeholder feedback, and varying shifts in the local context. This flexibility ensures that the SEF approach remains relevant and responsive throughout the project lifecycle.

The core purpose of this framework is to foster open communication and collaboration among all the actors. One of its main goals is to promote transparency in decision-making and project implementation. It also aims to build mutual trust between institutions and communities. Another key objective is to support and strengthen local project ownership and its outcomes. Once the communities feel ownership, they are more likely to support and sustain the services introduced.

SEF equally encourages active participation from all stakeholder groups. These include government departments, local authorities (such as NCs and TMAs), civil society organizations, and community members. Special efforts will be made to include women, youth, persons with disabilities, and other marginalized groups. Inclusive engagement ensures that the voices of all community members are heard and considered.

Open and inclusive dialogue is a guiding principle of this framework. Stakeholders will have multiple opportunities to share feedback, raise concerns, and influence decisions. Various communication methods will be used to support this process, including community meetings, focus group discussions (FGDs), mobile outreach and local media.

By involving stakeholders in a meaningful way, the project becomes more aligned with community priorities, enhancing the relevance and acceptance of project activities. Engaged communities are more likely to contribute to the success and sustainability of the project. In the long term, this approach helps to establish transparent and accountable local systems. These systems will be better equipped to deliver essential services in water supply, sanitation, and solid waste management (SWM).

2. Objectives of Stakeholder Engagement

- **Ensure proactive stakeholder engagement at all stages of the project:**

The framework is committed to engaging stakeholders in a timely and deliberate manner across all phases of the RIF-II Project—ranging from initial planning and design to implementation, monitoring, and evaluation. This continuous engagement ensures that stakeholders remain informed, consulted, and actively involved in shaping project outcomes.

- **Promote transparency, accountability, and inclusivity:**

A key focus of SEF is to establish open communication channels and decision-making processes that are transparent and easily understood. It aims to hold all implementing partners accountable to communities and stakeholders while ensuring that voices from all segments of society, including the underrepresented, are heard and considered.

- **Empower marginalized and vulnerable groups, particularly women:**

Special attention is given to enabling the meaningful participation of groups that are often excluded from development processes. This includes creating safe, accessible spaces for women and other vulnerable populations to express their needs, contribute ideas, and influence decisions that directly affect their lives and communities.

- **Facilitate participatory planning, implementation, and monitoring:**

It promotes a participatory approach in which stakeholders are not just passive recipients of services, but active contributors to project planning, execution, and oversight. Their involvement helps align project activities with local priorities, increases transparency, and improves accountability throughout the project cycle.

- **Incorporate stakeholder insights to shape project design and risk management:**

Stakeholder feedback and local knowledge are integral to refining project strategies and mitigating potential risks. By systematically gathering and integrating stakeholder perspectives, the project becomes more adaptive, context-sensitive, and resilient to unforeseen challenges.

3. Stakeholder Identification and Analysis

The following Chapter outlines the relevant stakeholders that need to be considered during the implementation of the RIF-II project. The table below provides a general overview followed by a detailed outline.

Table 1: Overview of Stakeholders

Stakeholder Category	Name/Institution	Role/Interest	Level of Influence	Engagement Strategy
Primary	Community Members (Men, Women, Youth, Marginalized Groups)	Beneficiaries, service users	Medium	Community meetings, FGDs
Institutional	TMA, PHED, LGRDD	Service delivery, coordination	High	Planning workshops, briefings
Local Governance	NCs, VCs	Local representation and oversight	High	Regular meetings
Secondary	CSO, CBOs	Support, advocacy, implementation partners	Medium	Joint fieldwork, consultations
Private Sector	Contractors, Service Providers	Implementation support	Low-Medium	Contractual meetings
Donors/Partners	KfW/Dorsch Impact/NEC/Cynosure	Financing, oversight	High	Reporting, review sessions

3.1. Primary Stakeholders

Primary stakeholders are those who are directly affected by the project and play a central role in shaping and sustaining its outcomes. These include:

- **Community Members** – This group comprises men, women, youth, and marginalized populations living in the target areas. Their daily lives are directly influenced by project interventions, especially in sectors like water supply, sanitation and solid SWM.
- **Neighbourhood Councils (NCs)** – As the most immediate form of local governance, NCs serve as key intermediaries between the community and government institutions. Their involvement in planning, prioritization, and oversight helps ensure that the project responds to local needs.
- **NC/VC and Tehsil-Level Leaders** – This group includes traditional leaders such as Maliks, respected elders and religious figures. They hold influence and legitimacy within the community and can play a vital role in mobilizing participation, addressing grievances, and promoting social cohesion.

3.2. Institutional Stakeholders

Institutional stakeholders are government bodies responsible for planning, regulation, service delivery, and oversight. Their support and coordination are essential for effective project implementation, which include:

- **Tehsil Municipal Administration (TMA)** – Responsible for urban and semi-urban service delivery, including sanitation and SWM. TMAs are key implementers and partners in ensuring infrastructure functionality and service efficiency.

- **Local Government and Rural Development Department (LGRDD)** – Oversees functioning of local governments, including NCs and VCs. It plays a critical role in governance reforms, policy support, and resource allocation under the SEF.
- **Public Health Engineering Department (PHED)** – Primarily responsible for water supply infrastructure and public health-related engineering services. Their technical expertise and involvement are vital for ensuring water quality and sustainability of systems.

3.3. Secondary Stakeholders

Secondary stakeholders are those who may not be directly impacted by the project but can influence its success through collaboration, social support, and service delivery. These include:

- **Local Non-Governmental Organizations (NGOs) and Community-Based Organizations (CBOs)** – These entities often have deep community ties and can support awareness-raising, community mobilization and capacity-building activities.
- **Private Sector Actors** – Includes contractors, service providers, entrepreneurs and consultants who may be engaged for infrastructure development, waste collection, and other service-related functions. Their role is essential in ensuring quality and timely implementation.
- **Development Partners and Donors (if applicable)** – These may include international or national funding agencies supporting the RIF-II project. They contribute resources, technical expertise, and monitoring mechanisms to enhance project outcomes.

4. Stakeholder Engagement Strategies

Based on the different stakeholders engagement strategies differ and are outlined in this chapter the table below provides an overview of approaches.

Table 2: Stakeholder Engagement methods

Stakeholder Category	Engagement Approach	Frequency	Tools/Methods
Community members	Awareness sessions, FGDs, transect walks, community meetings	Monthly or as required	Visual tools, flyers, participatory rural appraisal
NC representatives	Regular coordination meetings, joint planning sessions	Bi-monthly	Meeting minutes, feedback forms
TMA, PHED and LGRDD	Technical briefings, planning workshops	Quarterly	Joint planning templates, MoUs
NGOs/CBOs	Partnership building, consultations	Bi-monthly	Consultative meetings, joint field activities
Women, youth, minorities	Targeted FGDs, individual meetings	Regular (needs based)	Gender-sensitive facilitation, separate sessions
Religious leaders	During sermons (waaz), religious leaders can convey key messages.	Regular (needs based)	Utilize mosques and other places of worship for disseminating messages.
Local Elders	Routine discussion and decisions. Community meetings.	Regular (needs based)	Social gathering. Corner meetings

4.1. Key Activities in Stakeholder Engagement

This chapter outlines key activities and the means of stakeholder engagement planned. Table 2 below provides a general overview which is further elaborated in the text.

Table 3: Activities for Stakeholder Engagement

Phase	Activity	Tools/Methods Used	Frequency	Responsible Entity
Inception	Kickoff Workshops and Intro Meetings	Presentations, Feedback Sessions	Month 1-2	Implementation Consultants
	Stakeholder Mapping	Stakeholder Matrix, Profiling	Month 1	Consultant/CSO
	FGDs and Transect Walks	PRA Tools, Notes	Month 2	Social Mobilization (CSO+ Expert)
Implementation	Monthly Coordination Meetings	Meeting Minutes, Agendas	Monthly	TMA/PHED/NCs
	Community Meetings	Flyers, Visual Aids	Bi-monthly	CSO
	Monitoring Visits	Checklists, Field Reports	Quarterly	CSO + Committees
	Trainings (Technical and Soft Skills)	Training Manuals, Sessions	As scheduled	CSO, TMA, PHED
Operation and Maintenance (O&M) Phase	Handover to Local Institutions	Signing Ceremony	End of project	TMA, PHED, NCs, Committees
	O&M Committee Activation and Training	Manual, On-site support	Final quarter	CSO, Local Govt
	Tariff Awareness and Cost Recovery	Community Dialogues	Final quarter	TMA/CSO

	Grievance Mechanism Awareness	Posters, Community Forums	Ongoing	NCs, Local Mobilizers
--	-------------------------------	---------------------------	---------	-----------------------

- **Kick-off Workshops (Already Conducted):**

These initial workshops were organized to introduce the project to key stakeholders, clarify roles and responsibilities of different actors (such as NCs, TMAs, PHED, and community members), and collect preliminary feedback to inform about implementation strategies.

- **Transect Walks with Communities:**

These are participatory field visits conducted alongside community members to visually identify local challenges and opportunities. The walks help in mapping infrastructure, service gaps, environmental issues, and potential areas for intervention at the grassroots level.

- **Focus Group Discussions (FGDs):**

FGDs are conducted with specific target groups such as women, youth, marginalized groups, and service providers to gather qualitative insights on community priorities, perceived challenges, local knowledge, and cultural dynamics relevant to the project.

- **Surveys:**

Structured and standardized surveys are used to collect quantitative baseline data and enable systematic monitoring throughout the project cycle. These surveys help measure service delivery levels, community satisfaction, and behavioural change over time.

- **Trainings & Capacity-Building Sessions:**

Customized training sessions are designed for Neighbourhood Council (NC) members, Tehsil Municipal Administration (TMA), Public Health Engineering Department (PHED) staff, and community leaders. These sessions focus on enhancing technical, managerial, and participatory skills essential for improved governance and effective service delivery.

- **Formation of Community-Based Committees (COs/VOs, Water User Groups, and Sanitation / Solid Waste Committees):**

These grassroots-level structures are established to ensure community participation in project monitoring, local-level decision-making, and collective action. They play a key role in facilitating dialogue, sharing feedback, promoting local ownership, and addressing operational challenges.

- **Feedback and Grievance Redress Mechanism:**

A transparent, accessible, and responsive system will be established to collect community feedback and redress grievances related to project implementation. This mechanism may include tools such as complaint boxes, suggestion registers, community meetings, dedicated phone lines, or digital platforms. The objective is to promote accountability, build trust, and ensure timely resolution of concerns raised by beneficiaries.

- **Public-Private Partnership (PPP) Model:**

It aims to enhance service delivery in sectors such as water supply, sanitation, and SWM by leveraging the technical expertise, efficiency, and resources of the private sector. This model promotes collaboration between local government institutions (NCs, TMAs, PHED) and private actors such as local contractors, entrepreneurs, and community-based organizations through performance-based contracts and shared responsibilities. It encourages community involvement in monitoring, introduces cost-sharing or user-fee mechanisms where feasible, and ensures accountability through transparent oversight, ultimately contributing to more sustainable and responsive public services.

4.2. Communication Methods

The following communication approaches should be employed to effectively engage with the community:

- **Information Boards and Printed Flyers in Public Areas:**

Posters, banners, and flyers will be displayed in high-traffic public places such as mosques, markets, health centers, and schools. These materials will use simple language and illustrations to convey key information. Visual aids will help reach community members who are illiterate or semi-literate.

- **Verbal Briefings and Use of Local Language:**

Project teams, local elders, and leaders will deliver key messages through face-to-face briefings. Information will be shared using the local language spoken by the community. This approach ensures that messages are clear and easily understood by all, especially those who cannot read or write. Verbal communication also allows for immediate feedback and questions.

- **Public Messaging through Local FM Radio (Where Available):**

In areas with local FM stations, short public service announcements and educational segments will be aired. Radio is a powerful tool for reaching large audiences, including those in remote or rural areas. It also helps reinforce messages already delivered through other channels.

- **Mobile Communication and WhatsApp Groups:**

Updates and important announcements will be shared via mobile phones. WhatsApp groups will be created for different community segments, including youth, elders, and women. This method allows for fast, low-cost and targeted communication. It also enables two-way interaction between project teams and community members.

All communication efforts will be inclusive and culturally appropriate. Messages will be tailored to ensure they are accessible to everyone, including illiterate, semi-literate and marginalized groups. Extra attention will be paid to ensure women, youth, and vulnerable populations are actively informed and involved throughout the process.

The table below outlines the suggested methods for stakeholder engagement.

Table 4: Tools for Stakeholder Engagement

Tool	Purpose
Stakeholder Mapping Matrix	Identify interest and influence
PRA Tools	Community mapping, problem ranking
Questionnaires/Checklists	Structured data collection
Feedback Forms	Collect event/session feedback
Meeting Registers	Track participation
Communication Materials	Flyers, posters in local languages
WhatsApp/SMS	Real-time updates and coordination

5. Roles and Responsibilities

- **Consultant / Social Mobilization Team:**

The consultant and social mobilization team will play a central role in leading the community engagement process. They will plan and organize awareness sessions, public meetings and community mobilization events. They are responsible for conducting FGDs with different groups, including men, women, youth and marginalized populations. Their role includes documenting community feedback and concerns. They will help identify social barriers, opportunities and priorities raised by the community. They will also ensure that community perspectives are incorporated into project planning and decision-making. Additionally, they will support in building trust between the community and implementing institutions.

- **Local Coordinator (from Civil Society Organization – CSO):**

The local coordinator will act as a field-level focal person. They will coordinate all project activities happening on the ground. Their main task is to engage with community members on a daily basis. They will ensure that the right people are informed and invited to meetings and discussions. They will support logistics, such as arranging venues, materials and ensuring smooth flow of communication. The coordinator will also provide regular updates from the field to the project team. They will identify any field-level issues early on and help resolve them in coordination with local actors.

- **Neighbourhood Councils (NCs):**

NC members will serve as key community representatives in the project. They will help identify pressing local needs and challenges based on their knowledge and community input. NCs will support in prioritizing issues such as sanitation, water supply, and SWM. They will mobilize community members to participate in meetings, site visits and engagement sessions. They will also ensure that the voices of women, youth and vulnerable groups are included. Their involvement will help build community trust and ownership of the project. NCs will also help in monitoring project activities and providing local-level oversight.

- **Tehsil Municipal Administration (TMA) and Relevant Departments:**

TMA, along with departments such as PHED and LGRDD, will provide technical expertise for the project. They will support the design and implementation of infrastructure and service-related components. Their input will ensure that the project aligns with local development plans and standards. They will facilitate linkages between the project and ongoing government services. TMA will also help in identifying existing gaps in service delivery and proposing technical solutions. They will collaborate with the project team to ensure timely and effective execution. Additionally, TMA staff may participate in training and capacity-building sessions to enhance coordination and service delivery performance.

6. Monitoring and Reporting

Maintain Engagement Logs and Meeting Records:

Keep a detailed log of all engagement-related activities throughout the project. It includes formal meetings, informal community discussions, FGDs, field visits, and stakeholder consultations. For each activity, record the date, time, and location. List all participants by name, role, and affiliation (e.g., NC member, TMA staff, local leader). Summarize the key points discussed, decisions made, and follow-up actions agreed upon. Include photos, attendance sheets, or minutes where possible. These records will provide a transparent trail of engagement and help monitor community involvement over time. They also support learning, reflection, and reporting.

Document All Feedback and Actions Taken:

Create a system to capture feedback from community members and stakeholders at all levels. This includes verbal feedback during meetings, written suggestions, phone calls, or messages through WhatsApp and other platforms. Categorize the feedback into themes such as service issues, infrastructure needs, social concerns, or implementation delays. For each concern or suggestion, document what action was taken, who was responsible, and the timeline for resolution. If a concern cannot be addressed, record the reason and communicate it back to the concerned individual or group. This process shows that feedback is valued and strengthens the relationship between the project and the community. It also allows for continuous improvement in project planning and delivery.

Include Stakeholder Engagement Updates in Monthly/Quarterly Progress Reports:

Every monthly or quarterly project progress report should include a specific section on stakeholder engagement. This section will provide a summary of all engagement activities conducted during the reporting period. It should include key statistics such as the number of meetings held, participants engaged, and feedback received. Highlight major community concerns and how they were addressed. Also report on any new committees formed, partnerships developed, or local contributions mobilized. Share success stories or positive outcomes from community involvement to demonstrate impact. This ensures all stakeholders, including donors and implementing partners, remain informed and aligned.

Periodic Review of Engagement Effectiveness with Adjustments as Needed:

Conduct periodic assessments to evaluate how well the engagement process is working. Review the frequency and quality of community interactions. Assess who is participating are women, youth and marginalized groups being included meaningfully? Check how quickly and effectively the project responds to community feedback. Use tools like feedback forms, community scorecards, or satisfaction surveys. Identify what's working well and where gaps exist. Based on these findings, revise engagement strategies—such as changing meeting times, using different communication tools, or increasing outreach in underrepresented areas. This ensures the engagement process stays inclusive, relevant, and responsive throughout the life of the project.

7. Risk Mitigation Measures

Low Participation:

There is a risk that some community members may not attend meetings or engage in project activities. This can happen due to lack of awareness, social barriers, or competing daily responsibilities. To address this, trusted local influencers will be engaged. These may include religious leaders, community elders, teachers, and respected NC members. They will play a key role in encouraging participation and spreading accurate information about the project. Special mobilization efforts will be made in areas with historically low engagement. House-to-house visits will be conducted to personally invite community members. Loudspeaker announcements will be made in mosques and public spaces to reach wider audiences. Invitations will be shared through WhatsApp groups and community noticeboards. Meetings will be held at times that are convenient for both men and women. Care will be taken to avoid religious events, market hours, or harvest periods. Childcare support may be arranged to help women attend. Feedback from previous sessions will be used to improve future engagement strategies.

Elite Capture:

There is a risk that influential individuals may dominate community discussions or decision-making processes. This may exclude the voices of less powerful or marginalized groups. To prevent this, facilitators will manage discussions to ensure fair and balanced participation. Ground rules will be established for respectful dialogue during meetings. Attendance will be monitored to ensure representation from all social, economic, and gender groups. Separate sessions will be organized for vulnerable groups. These may include women-only focus groups, youth circles, or special meetings for persons with disabilities. These forums will allow them to speak freely and without pressure. All feedback from these sessions will be recorded and included in the planning process. Participation sheets, meeting minutes, and action points will be reviewed to assess inclusiveness. Local CSOs and NC members will help identify and support the participation of underrepresented voices.

Mistrust in Institutions:

Many community members may have past experiences of unmet promises or failed projects. This can lead to scepticism and lack of trust in government institutions or implementing partners. To rebuild trust, open and honest communication will be prioritized from the beginning. The project's goals, roles of different actors, and expected outcomes will be clearly explained. Simple language will be used, and all materials will be translated into local languages. Information will be shared through channels trusted by the community. These include NCs, mosques, schools, and local leaders. Updates will be given regularly through community meetings, FM radio, flyers, and mobile messages. Feedback and grievance mechanisms will be made easily accessible. Complaints will be acknowledged quickly and resolved within a reasonable time. A log of complaints and actions taken will be maintained and reviewed publicly when appropriate. By being transparent, responsive, and inclusive, the project will demonstrate reliability. Over time, this consistent behaviour will help restore the community's confidence in institutions and the project team.

8. Stakeholder Engagement Strategy:

The project will adopt a structured strategy to engage all relevant stakeholders. The goal is to ensure that engagement is inclusive, timely and meaningful at every stage of the project. A variety of methods and tools will be used to reach different groups. These formats will be chosen based on the specific needs and characteristics of each stakeholder. Stakeholders vary in their level of influence, interest and technical capacity. Some may need detailed information and regular updates. Others may require simple explanations and occasional involvement.

The engagement plan will be flexible and responsive to these differences. Activities will be scheduled at appropriate times to maximize participation. Different formats will include verbal briefings, community meetings, focus group discussions, surveys and mobile communication. Local languages and culturally appropriate methods will be used to ensure accessibility. Special attention will be given to vulnerable groups, such as women, youth and persons with disabilities. They will be engaged through targeted approaches that allow them to participate fully and safely. Regular feedback will be collected and used to improve engagement methods. This approach will help build trust, ensure transparency, and promote active involvement from all stakeholders throughout the project cycle.

8.1. Formats of Engagement

Different formats will be used depending on the type of stakeholder and the objective of engagement:

Table 5: Format of Engagement

Format	Purpose	Target Stakeholders
Community Meetings	Raise awareness, gather information, promote local ownership	General community, NC members
Focus Group Discussions	In-depth understandings on specific issues	Community members, Women, youth, marginalized groups
Transect Walks	Joint field observations of local issues	Community members, NC, TMA staff
Workshops	Joint planning, coordination, and learning	NC, TMA, PHED, LGRDD
One-on-One Consultations	Key insights, high-level engagement	Line departments, local leaders
Surveys & Assessments	Collect baseline and monitoring data	Community households
Training Sessions	Capacity development	NC members, local volunteers, TMA and PHED staff

8.2. Tools for Engagement

To support the above formats, various tools will be used to encourage dialogue, simplify communication, and record participants' inputs:

Table 6: Engagement Tools

Tool	Use
Stakeholder Mapping Matrix	To identify and categorize stakeholders by interest and

	influence
PRA Tools	Mapping, problem ranking
Checklists and Questionnaires	For structured data collection in FGDs, surveys
Feedback Forms	For post-activity inputs and suggestions
Attendance Registers and Meeting Minutes	For documentation and monitoring participation
Communication Aids (flyers, posters)	Awareness raising in local languages
Visual Aids (maps, drawings)	To help explain technical concepts during field visits
Digital Tools (WhatsApp, SMS alerts)	For real-time updates and mobilization in remote areas

8.3. Schedule of Stakeholder Engagement Activities

Engagement will be scheduled across four phases of the project:

Table 7: Schedule

Phase	Key Activities	Timeline
Phase 1: Planning & Baseline	Kickoff workshops, stakeholder profiling and mapping, FGDs, community meetings, baseline survey	Month 4–5
Phase 2: Design & Mobilization	Planning and designing of training for NC, TMA and PHED members, consultations with line departments	Month 2–3
Phase 3: Implementation	Regular coordination meetings, grievance handling, monitoring visits	Month 4 onwards
Phase 4: Monitoring & Sustainability	Endline FGDs, follow-up workshops, community feedback sessions	Final 6 months of project

Note: Weekly and monthly calendars will be shared with local coordinators of CSO to ensure timely and synchronized implementation of activities.

9. Stakeholder Involvement Process during the Inception Phase

The inception phase is critical for establishing trust, clarifying roles, and ensuring stakeholder buy-in from the outset. During this phase, the project team will engage stakeholders through a structured and inclusive process to lay the foundation for collaborative planning and implementation. The key steps include:

9.1. Identification, Profiling and Mapping of Stakeholders

- A detailed stakeholder analysis will be conducted to identify all relevant actors at the, NCs, Urban VCs and community levels.
- Stakeholders will be categorized based on their level of influence, interest, and relevance to the project.
- A Stakeholder Mapping Matrix will be developed and validated through field consultations.

9.2. Introductory and Kick-off Meetings

- **Introductory sessions** with key government stakeholders (e.g., TMA, LGRDD, PHED) to align on project goals and clarify institutional linkages.
- **Tehsil-level kick-off workshops** involving NC/ urban VC members, community elders, and TMA/PHED representatives to present the project scope and seek early feedback.
- These sessions serve to generate awareness, clarify expectations, and build ownership among participants.

9.3. Preliminary Community Mobilization

- The social mobilization team, supported by local coordinators (CSO), will introduce the project at the grassroots level through:
 - Community meetings in accessible locations
 - Informal interactions with local influencers and elders

9.4. Participatory Assessment Activities

- **Transect walks** with community members and NC/ urban VC representatives to physically observe local issues and gather contextual information.
- **Focus Group Discussions (FGDs)** with targeted segments (e.g., men, women, youth, minority groups) to understand specific needs and perspectives.
- Collection of community feedback on service gaps, priorities, and possible risks through participatory tools.

9.5. Stakeholder Feedback Integration

- Inputs gathered from FGDs, transect walks, and workshops will be documented and analysed.
- This feedback will inform:
 - The design of NCs/VCs-specific Stakeholder Engagement Plans
 - Prioritization of project interventions

- Risk mitigation and communication strategies

9.6. Establishment of Local Coordination Mechanisms

- Identification or formation of community-based committees or working groups (if not already present), comprising NC/ urban VC members, women, and youth representatives.
- These groups will serve as the focal points for ongoing coordination and communication throughout the project lifecycle.

9.7. Communication and Documentation

- All interactions, feedback, and agreements during the inception phase will be formally documented.
- A summary report of stakeholder involvement in the inception phase will be prepared to:
 - Validate findings with stakeholders
 - Ensure transparency
 - Serve as a baseline for monitoring engagement effectiveness

10. Stakeholder Involvement Process During Project Implementation

During the project implementation phase, continuous, structured, and inclusive stakeholder engagement is essential to ensure transparency, promote accountability, support adaptive management, and enhance local ownership. The following process will guide stakeholder involvement throughout this critical phase:

10.1. Regular Coordination with Institutional Stakeholders

- **Monthly and quarterly coordination meetings** will be held with the TMAs, relevant line departments (e.g., PHED, LGRDD), and NCs to:
 - Review project progress
 - Align on implementation timelines
 - Resolve technical or administrative bottlenecks
- **Joint field visits** with TMA, PHED and NC representatives will help validate implementation activities on the ground.

10.2. Engagement with Community Stakeholders

- Community meetings and feedback forums will be organized at each major stage of implementation to:
 - Share updates on progress
 - Discuss work plans
 - Address grievances or community concerns
- Community-based monitoring groups, where established, will be involved in site supervision and reporting irregularities.

10.3. Participatory Monitoring and Reporting

- Local stakeholders, including community volunteers, youth groups, and NC/VC representatives, will be engaged in joint monitoring visits using simplified checklists or observation tools.
- Reports from these exercises will inform decision-making and mid-course corrections.

10.4. Stakeholder Involvement in Trainings and Capacity Building

- Targeted capacity-building sessions will be conducted for NC/NC members, TMA & PHED staff, and selected community members to:
 - Strengthen oversight and governance roles
 - Improve understanding of technical aspects (e.g., sanitation systems, O&M)
 - Promote sustainability and local resource mobilization

10.5. Grievance Redress and Conflict Resolution

- A functional and accessible Grievance Redress Mechanism (GRM) will be operational during implementation to capture complaints related to service quality, delays, exclusion, or misuse of resources.
- Communities will be sensitized on how to use the system through local announcements, posters, and NC facilitation.

Table 8 Grievance Redress Process

Component	Description
Access Channels	Community meetings, suggestion boxes, WhatsApp
Response Timeline	Within 5 working days
Escalation Pathway	From NC/VC → TMA → District Government
Documentation	Complaints register, resolution records

10.6. Adaptive Engagement and Feedback Integration

- Project implementation will be flexible and responsive to stakeholder feedback.
- Regular updates and changes in strategy (e.g., activity scheduling, target prioritization) will be communicated transparently to all relevant stakeholders.
- Feedback will be documented, categorized (e.g., suggestions, complaints, risks), and reflected in project management decisions.

10.7. Documentation and Knowledge Sharing

- Stakeholder engagement activities during implementation will be tracked through:
 - Attendance records
 - Engagement logs
 - Feedback tracking reports
- Best practices, success stories, and challenges will be compiled and shared with stakeholders to promote transparency, learning, and replication.

11. Stakeholder Involvement after Implementation

Sustaining project outcomes beyond the implementation phase requires continuous stakeholder engagement during the O&M period. This phase focuses on local ownership, system functionality, service quality, and community responsibility. The strategy outlined below ensures that stakeholders remain actively involved in safeguarding project investments and enhancing long-term impacts.

11.1. Handover and Ownership Transfer

- Upon completion, project assets and infrastructure will formally be handed over to the designated local institutions (e.g., TMA, NC, VC or CBO).
- A handover ceremony and agreement signing will mark the transition and reinforce accountability and ownership responsibilities.

11.2. Formation and Activation of O&M Committees

- Local O&M committees will be established or strengthened, consisting of:
 - NC/VC members
 - Community representatives (including women/youth)
 - Local service users (e.g., water user, sanitation and solid waste committees)
- These committees will be responsible for routine monitoring, reporting issues, and coordinating minor repairs with relevant departments.

11.3. Capacity Building for O&M

- Prior to handover, key stakeholders involved in service maintenance (e.g., NC secretaries, TMA workers, committee members) will receive technical and financial training.
- Training topics may include:
 - Preventive maintenance
 - Reporting mechanisms
 - Minor repairs
 - Record-keeping
 - Community mobilization for tariff collection

11.4. Community Participation in O&M

- Community members will be sensitized about their roles in safeguarding infrastructure and keeping services functional.
- Awareness campaigns will focus on:
 - Responsible usage
 - Reporting faults or leakages
 - Cleaning and hygiene practices
- Communities may contribute to a local fund or in-kind support for minor maintenance where feasible.

11.5. Institutional Support and Monitoring

- The project team will establish clear coordination protocols between O&M committees, NCs/VCs and TMA for:

- Escalation of technical issues
- Resource allocation
- Emergency response
- Periodic joint monitoring visits by NCs/VCs and TMA will ensure ongoing support and identify gaps in performance or sustainability.

11.6. Feedback Mechanism and Grievance Redress

- Existing grievance redress systems will be adapted to allow community members to:
 - Report service disruptions or damage
 - Suggest improvements
 - Raise accountability concerns
- All feedback will be logged, tracked, and reported to relevant authorities for timely response.

11.7. Tariff Collection and Cost Recovery (where applicable)

- If services require recurring expenditures (e.g., water supply, waste management), a structured tariff system will be introduced in consultation with the community.
- The community will be involved in:
 - Setting affordable tariffs
 - Selecting responsible persons for collection
 - Monitoring the use of collected funds for service upkeep

11.8. Learning and Documentation

- Lessons learned, challenges, and successful O&M practices will be documented and shared with stakeholders to support replication and continuous improvement.
- Regular review meetings (quarterly/bi-annually) will provide a platform for all stakeholders to reflect and make necessary adjustments.

12. Strategies for the Engagement and Mobilization of Women

The active engagement and mobilization of women are essential to ensure inclusivity, equity, and effectiveness in project planning, implementation, and sustainability. Recognizing the unique roles, perspectives, and challenges faced by women in traditionally conservative areas of DI Khan and Bannu. The following strategies are designed to enhance their participation meaningfully and respectfully:

12.1. Gender-Sensitive Stakeholder Mapping

- During the stakeholder assessment phase, women will be specifically identified as a distinct stakeholder group.
- Mapping will include local female leaders, women's organizations, teachers, health workers, and influential female voices within the community.

Table 9: Gender Sensitive Strategies

Strategy	Implementation Detail
Women-Only FGDs	Led by female facilitators
Safe and Accessible Locations	Use trusted local spaces
Representation in Committees	Where possible
Flexible Timings	Scheduled around daily responsibilities
Female Leadership Mentoring	Identify and train community women leaders
Partner with Women-Focused Groups	Collaboration with health, education actors

12.2. Separate and Safe Spaces for Engagement

- Women-only meetings, FGDs, and consultations will be conducted in culturally acceptable, safe, and accessible locations to ensure comfort and freedom of expression.
- Female facilitators and social mobilizers will lead these engagements to build trust and rapport.

12.3. Inclusion in Community Committees and Decision-Making

- Efforts will be made to ensure adequate female representation in:
 - Neighborhood Council consultations
 - Community-based monitoring or O&M committees
 - Project design and feedback groups
- Where possible, project guidelines will require a minimum target for women's participation in committees and training sessions.

12.4. Tailored Communication and Mobilization Approaches

- Use of gender-sensitive messaging in local languages through:
 - Home visits
 - Women-specific gatherings
- Use of visual aids, storytelling, and informal networks to engage semi-literate or illiterate women.

12.5. Timing and Scheduling Flexibility

- Activities involving women will be scheduled at times that do not conflict with household responsibilities, religious duties, or childcare needs.
- Flexible formats, such as short sessions will be used where needed.

12.6. Capacity Building and Leadership Development

- Customized training sessions for women on topics such as:
 - Leadership and advocacy
 - Health and hygiene (especially in WASH-related projects)
 - Civic rights and responsibilities
- Identify and mentor local female to serve as mobilizers and community focal points.

12.7. Partnership with Women-Focused Institutions

- Collaborate with local women's groups, female school teachers, health units, and NGOs that have established trust and networks with women in the community.
- These partnerships will strengthen outreach, mobilization, and feedback collection.

12.8. Monitoring and Reporting Gender Participation

- All project monitoring tools will include gender-disaggregated data to track women's involvement across all phases.
- Regular review of women's engagement indicators will inform adaptive strategies to address gaps or barriers.

12.9. Addressing Cultural and Social Barriers

- Work with male community leaders, elders, and religious figures to advocate for women's participation.
- Emphasize how women's involvement strengthens household and community well-being, framing it with in local values and beliefs.
- Provide transportation (where feasible) to remove practical barriers to participation.

13. Conclusion

Following the completion of social actor profiling and mapping, the subsequent task is to develop the stakeholders' engagement plan. Prior to executing this task, it is essential to design and comprehend the stakeholders' engagement framework.

This framework offers a systematic approach to guarantee stakeholder participation at every phase of the project. It fosters participatory techniques and inclusive practices to enhance results and bolster accountability. Additionally, the strategy promotes local ownership and builds trust. The framework is crafted to be organized, inclusive, and adaptable to local contexts. It employs a combination of participatory formats, customized tools, and phased timelines.

These approaches aim to forge robust partnerships with communities and encourage institutional collaboration across NCs and Urban VCs.

In the inception phase, prioritizing early and inclusive stakeholder engagement is crucial. This fosters a sense of ownership and ensures that the project aligns with local needs. Involving stakeholders from the outset enhances the project's relevance, legitimacy, and long-term viability. Active participation persists throughout the implementation phase.

This guarantees that the project remains aligned with local realities. It also aids in sustaining public trust and delivering services transparently and inclusively. This participatory methodology not only improves service delivery but also fortifies local institutions and enhances community capacity for future development.

The project will place a strong emphasis on the participation of women. Customized, respectful, and culturally sensitive strategies will be employed to ensure their inclusion. The voices and leadership of women are crucial in identifying priorities, managing services, and ensuring equitable access to project benefits.

The project will give special attention to women's participation. Tailored, respectful, and culturally appropriate strategies will be used to ensure their inclusion. Women's voices and leadership are vital in identifying priorities, managing services, and promoting fair access to project benefits.

Stakeholder involvement during the O&M period ensures continuity, reliability, and accountability in service delivery. By empowering local institutions and communities through capacity building, coordination mechanisms, and transparent oversight, the project strengthens long-term sustainability and resilience of the established systems.

Annex 5

PD Transfer Notification



**GOVERNMENT OF
KHYBER PAKHTUNKHWA
ESTABLISHMENT DEPARTMENT**

Dated Peshawar July 22, 2025

NOTIFICATION

NO. SO(E-I)/E&AD/1-664/2025. The following posting/transfer of officers is hereby ordered, in the public interest, with immediate effect: -

SR#	NAME OF THE OFFICER	FROM	TO
1.	Mr. Umara Khan (PAS BS-19)	Additional Secretary, Zakat, Ushr, Social Welfare, Special Education & Women Empowerment Department	Director (Admin), Directorate General of Industries, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, against the vacant post.
2.	Ms. Shahida Bibi (PAS BS-19)	Awaiting posting in Establishment Department	Secretary, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa Commission on the Status of Women, Zakat & Ushr Department vice Sr. No. 04.
3.	Muhammad Saleh (PMS BS-19)	Project Director, Regional Infrastructure Fund-II in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa improving Resilient Resource Management in Cities, P&D Department	Additional Secretary, Elementary & Secondary Education Department, against the vacant post.
4.	Ms. Tabassum (PMS BS-19)	Secretary, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa Commission on the Status of Women, Zakat & Ushr Department	Additional Secretary, Zakat, Ushr, Social Welfare, Special Education & Women Empowerment Department, vice Sr. No. 01.

**CHIEF SECRETARY
GOVERNMENT OF KHYBER PAKHTUNKHWA**

Endst. No. & date even.

Copy forwarded to the: -

1. Senior Member Board of Revenue, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa.
2. Additional Chief Secretary, P&D Department.
3. Additional Chief Secretary, Home & Tribal Affairs Department.
4. Principal Secretary to Governor, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa
5. Principal Secretary to Chief Minister, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa.
6. All Administrative Secretaries to Government of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (concerned).
7. Accountant General, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa.
8. Director General, Information & Public Relations, Peshawar.
9. Director General, Industries, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa.
10. Secretary, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa Commission on the Status of Women, Zakat, Ushr & Social Welfare Department.
11. Director (PD) and Section Officer (E-/PAS), Establishment Division, Islamabad.
12. PS to Secretary (Estt)/Special Secretary (Estt)/ Special Secretary (R)/PA to AS(Estt)/AS (HRD)/ SO(Secret)/ SO(HRD-I) & SO(E-II) Establishment Department.
13. PS to Secretary (Admn)/AS(Admn)/D.S.(Admn)/SO(Transport)/Estate Officer and ACSO Cypher Administration Department.
14. PS to Managing Director, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa IT Board. Peshawar.

Annex 6

NOC Armored SUV



KfW



11 July 2025

To:

The Project Director
Regional Infrastructure Project (RIF – II)
Urban Planning Unit
University Town, Abdara Road
Peshawar.

Subject: Request for Issuance of No Objection Certificate (NOC) for Procurement of Bulletproof SUV for Foreign-Funded Development Project (RIF – II) in Bannu and Dera Ismail Khan Districts

Dear Sir,

I am taking this opportunity to write on behalf of **Regional Infrastructure Fund – II (RIF – II)**, funded by KfW – The German International Development Bank. It is an initiative implemented by **Dorsch Impact** lead consortium in partnership with the Government of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (GoKP). The project operates in the security-sensitive southern Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, the two districts of Bannu and Dera Ismail Khan. It is aimed at promoting inclusive development, peacebuilding, and resilience in conflict-affected communities, mainly focusing on water supply, wastewater management (sanitation) and solid waste management.

Given the prevailing security challenges in the region, the project team—comprising both national and international staff—is frequently exposed to potential threats. To ensure the safety and mobility of project personnel while maintaining continuity of field operations, we seek to procure a **bulletproof SUV (Toyota Landcruiser)** as per the donor's security and operational compliance standards.

We therefore request the GoKP to approach the Federal Government, Ministry of Interior, for the issuance of a **NOC** for the procurement and registration of the bulletproof vehicle under the project's operational framework.

Please let us know if you need any additional support documents for your kind support and facilitation.

We assure the GoKP that the vehicle will be used strictly for project-related field activities, and its use will be governed by all applicable laws, security protocols, and coordination mechanisms with relevant civil and security authorities.

Your kind support in expediting the issuance of the NOC will be highly appreciated please.

Your Sincerely,
Muhammad Ayaz Khan
International Team Lead, RIF – II

CC to: Dorsch Impact

Implementation Consultants :



CYNOSURE



Annex 7

Detailed Security Report (May – July 2025)

1. Summary

In this quarter, the districts of Bannu, DI Khan, Lakki Marwat, Tank, Karak, North Waziristan, and South Waziristan experienced a significant escalation in militant activity. The overall trend across these three months indicated an increase in militant-related violence, particularly marked by the surge in militants killed (rising from 56 in May to 154 in July). Arrests peaked in June, suggesting robust intelligence-based operations, while July saw an apparent shift toward more kinetic engagements. The use of Improvised Explosive Devices (IEDs), target killings, abductions, and fire raids intensified, especially in urban and border fringe zones, pointing to a strategic transformation in militant tactics. The impact on civilians remained high, particularly in Bannu, while extortion remained a persistent, though underreported, challenge in areas with limited law enforcement presence.

From May through July 2025, the region encompassing Bannu Division and the former FATA districts witnessed evolving patterns of militancy that reflected both militant resurgence and state pushback.

In Bannu, May witnessed devastating civilian casualties, with 13 civilians killed and 33 injured. However, a shift occurred in June, where 40 militants were arrested, and no civilians were killed. This reflects an aggressive sweep operation or counter-terrorism initiative that succeeded in disrupting militant networks temporarily. Yet by July, the trend reversed with a renewed wave of violence: 10 IEDs were reported, along with 8 targeted killings and 9 civilian injuries, signaling a potential reprisal from militant outfits in response to June's crackdowns. This cyclical pattern where aggressive law enforcement actions provoke retaliatory militant attacks suggests a fragile security equilibrium.

DI Khan remained a consistent but lower-profile conflict zone. Noteworthy was the alarming rise in abductions during June with 19 cases suggesting an operational preference for leveraging hostages for ransom, bargaining, or intimidation. Civilian casualties remained relatively low, though this could indicate either selective targeting or underreporting. The strategic significance of D.I. Khan as a gateway to both Punjab and tribal districts makes it vulnerable to cross-border militant logistics and sleeper cell operations.

In Tank, the situation remained quiet until July, which saw a sharp rise in militant killings (17), likely the result of security operations or clashes. This sudden shift suggests Tank is emerging as a new operational hub or fallback zone for militants displaced from neighbouring districts. The district's proximity to South Waziristan and its mixed topography makes it conducive for small militant groups to maneuver, hide, and strike unpredictably.

Lakki Marwat saw consistent activity across all three months, particularly with regard to IED incidents and target killings. The region recorded high civilian injuries in June, possibly pointing to increased collateral damage or intentional soft-target tactics. The geography of Lakki flat and open makes it susceptible to remote-triggered IEDs and ambushes.

Karak, though largely spared from large-scale attacks, showed signs of strategic significance. With low militant engagement and occasional arrests and abductions, it appears to serve more as a logistical route or safe transit corridor rather than a direct conflict zone. However, even sporadic incidents in Karak warrant attention due to its connection to southern Punjab and central KP routes.

North Waziristan remained the most turbulent district, witnessing extensive kinetic operations. Militant fatalities were highest in June (63) and remained significant in July (53), indicating

ongoing counter-militancy efforts. The region also faced increased IED activity, reflecting the insurgents' continued capacity to disrupt security movements and infrastructure. Given its history as a militant stronghold and complex tribal demography, North Waziristan remains a barometer for the wider militancy trend.

South Waziristan followed a similar trend. July marked a major escalation with 56 militants killed and a noticeable rise in target killings and IED attacks. The numbers suggest that militants are regrouping in this area or that it is being used as a fallback base amid operations elsewhere. The rugged terrain and historic safe havens in the region continue to pose challenges to sustained law enforcement presence.

Across the region, a few trends stand out. The use of IEDs, fire raids, and targeted assassinations has increased markedly, indicating a shift toward guerrilla-style warfare. These tactics allow militants to sustain pressure while minimizing their own casualties. The rise in civilian targeting, especially during May and July suggests a deliberate attempt to weaken local resistance, punish informants, and instill fear in communities.

Abductions, particularly in D.I. Khan, have become a tool not just of terror but also of resource extraction and psychological dominance. While extortion incidents appear low on record, local knowledge and context confirm that they are far more prevalent, especially in regions where the militants exert territorial or psychological control. Militants now prefer silent extortion through intermediaries and encrypted messaging apps, reducing visibility while maintaining financial inflow.

An important pattern is the militant groups' ability to adapt quickly to state responses. When high-profile arrests occur, retaliatory attacks follow within days or weeks, particularly in soft-target regions. Similarly, militant recruitment seems to have localized elements, with disgruntled youth from conflict-prone areas being lured into militancy through ideology, coercion, or economic desperation.

Looking forward, the trend indicates a likely continuation of asymmetric attacks, greater urban infiltration, and persistent threats to both security forces and civilians. Civilian spaces are increasingly becoming contested zones, and the targeting of community figures or business leaders will likely continue as part of the militants' strategy to assert dominance and extract resources.

2. Strategic Outlook and Additional Observations

Fragmentation among militant factions is increasing, with splinter groups engaging in freelance operations outside central command structures. This has led to a spike in unpredictable, high-casualty attacks. Urban peripheries in Bannu and D.I. Khan, being the emerging as soft target zones, are requiring special surveillance and counter-intelligence setups.

Encrypted messaging apps such as WhatsApp and Telegram have become the primary medium for issuing threats, coordinating movements, and managing extortion operations. These platforms reduce traceability and complicate law enforcement's response mechanisms.

The deliberate targeting of civilians particularly informants, elders, and business figures demonstrates militants' strategy to reassert community-level dominance through psychological warfare. The pattern of retaliatory attacks following arrests or crackdowns indicates militants' determination to maintain influence and deter community collaboration with state actors.

Furthermore, militants appear to be capitalizing on jurisdictional blind spots by moving between districts like Tank, Karak, and Lakki Marwat, exploiting administrative fragmentation. Enhanced inter-district coordination and mobile task forces could mitigate these risks.

The civilian population continues to experience chronic stress and reduced resilience due to constant exposure to threats, extortion, and targeted violence. This deteriorating mental security undermines the long-term prospects of peace and development.

3. Evolving Militant Threat Landscape

Militant outfits once driven by ideology such as ISIS-K, (Islamic State Khorasan) TTP, Jamaat-ul-Ahrar, and BLA have transformed into profit-driven criminal networks. Operating primarily from Afghan territory, these groups conduct cross-border extortion, kidnapping, and ransom operations targeting Pakistani civilians, including businessmen and traders.

Intelligence confirms these operations are often planned and financed from safe havens in eastern and southeastern Afghanistan. Victims are held in cross-border hideouts, with payments routed through untraceable financial channels. Groups like ISIS-K have even issued fatwas promoting cybercrime for fundraising.

The ideological front has largely given way to mafia-style turf wars, with leadership coordinating transnational crimes via encrypted communications and shared logistics. Infighting is now driven by revenue disputes rather than ideological rifts, marking a shift from militant insurgency to organized criminal enterprise.

Simultaneously, militants in KP, Balochistan, and along the Durand Line are leveraging low-cost, high-impact technologies drones, digital surveillance, and cyber tactics for reconnaissance, intimidation, and direct attacks. Their evolving tactics pose a hybrid threat: part insurgency, part criminal syndicate, with strategic depth across the Afghan frontier.

4. Emerging Technologies used by Militants

4.1. Quadcopters and Commercial Drones

Militants have adopted commercial quadcopters for:

- Surveillance of security posts, troop movements, and checkpoints.
- Mapping routes for infiltration or IED placements.
- Dropping payloads such as grenades or small concussion-based explosives.

These drones are often modified with night vision cameras, remote detonation systems, and encrypted FPV (First Person View) systems. Such methods are inspired by practices seen in Iraq, Syria, and Afghanistan and are now appearing in North Waziristan and border areas.

4.2. Encrypted Communication Apps

Groups like TTP factions and ISIS-K are heavily reliant on encrypted messaging platforms such as Telegram, Briar, and Zello. They also use modified WhatsApp clones that offer location masking and remote wipe features. This poses a challenge to signal intelligence units and delays real-time interception.

4.3. IED Detonation via GSM/Radio

Militants are increasingly using GSM-triggered IEDs hidden inside motorcycles, trash containers, or roadside culverts. Common tools include basic mobile phones as receivers and car remotes or drone controls as triggers. The low cost and wide availability make these systems hard to track and disrupt.

4.4. Use of Digital Propaganda

Militant groups produce short videos using drones, action footage, and edited martyrdom clips. These are distributed through Telegram channels and WhatsApp groups to boost recruitment and psychological warfare. Digital content is tailored for both local and international audiences.

4.5. GPS and Offline Mapping Tools

Militants use free tools like Locus Map, OruxMaps, and OpenStreetMap-based apps for offline navigation. These tools help plan movement through difficult terrain without reliance on mobile data a common need in regions like D.I. Khan or the Koh-e-Sulaiman range.

4.6. Assessment

The proliferation of cheap, dual-use technology has created a low-cost, high-impact threat environment. Militants are rapidly adapting to technology faster than conventional forces.

Countermeasures must include:

- Drone jammers in high-risk areas.
- Upgraded SIGINT capability.
- Specialized counter-drone training for security forces.

5. Conclusion

The security landscape in southern Khyber Pakhtunkhwa and adjoining tribal districts is becoming increasingly volatile. While security forces have made gains, the resurgence of militant activity, especially in urban centers and transitional zones, demands continued vigilance, community engagement, and refined intelligence-based operations to pre-empt further escalation. It is imperative that the state adopts a multi-pronged strategy merging kinetic action with community-based intelligence and economic rehabilitation to sustainably neutralize militant influence and prevent long-term radicalization.

a. Incident Table for May 2025

For an easy perception and understanding of the on-going violence, above narrated militancy incidents have also been interpreted in numerical terms, which are being presented in the following table:

#	Districts	Militants Killed	Militants Injured	Militants Arrested	Law Enforcing Killed	Law Enforcing Injured	Civilians Killed	Civilians Injured	Improvised Explosive Devices	Target Killings	Abductions	Fire Raid	Extortions
1	Bannu	11	3	0	7	1	1	33	1	2	4	2	0
2	DI Khan	4	1	2	1	6	0	1	1	0	2	4	0
3	Tank	1	3	0	1	0	1	0	2	0	9	1	3
4	Lakki	16	1	0	1	0	2	2	6	0	5	2	1
5	Karak	0	0	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	0
6	N. Waziristan	14	0	2	8	6	6	3	1	0	2	3	0
7	S. Waziristan	10	0	1	10	6	3	1	2	0	2	1	0
	Total:	56	8	9	28	19	13	40	13	2	25	13	4

b. Incident Table for June 2025

For an easy perception and understanding of the on-going violence, above narrated militancy incidents have also been interpreted in numerical terms, which are being presented in the following table:

#	Districts	Militants Killed	Militants Injured	Militants Arrested	Law Enforcing Killed	Law Enforcing Injured	Civilians Killed	Civilians Injured	Improvised Explosive Devices	Target Killings	Abductions	Fire Raid	Extortions
1	Bannu	24	3	40	0	1	0	0	3	2	0	3	1
2	DI Khan	10	9	1	0	2	2	1	0	1	19	0	1
3	Tank	0	0	0	2	0	2	0	3	0	4	0	0
4	Lakki	11	0	0	3	6	0	16	3	3	0	1	0
5	Karak	0	0	2	1	1	0	2	0	1	2	0	0
6	N. Waziristan	63	19	0	14	17	4	11	3	7	1	3	0
7	S. Waziristan	25	0	0	6	10	2	13	2	2	2	6	0
	Total:	133	31	43	26	37	10	44	14	16	28	13	2

c. Incident Table for July 2025

For an easy perception and understanding of the on-going violence, above narrated militancy incidents have also been interpreted in numerical terms, which are being presented in the following table:

#	Districts	Militants Killed	Militants Injured	Militants Arrested	Law Enforcing Killed	Law Enforcing Injured	Civilians Killed	Civilians Injured	Improvised Explosive Devices	Target Killings	Abductions	Fire Raid	Extortions
1	Bannu	12	3	0	1	7	6	10	10	4	8	6	0
2	DI Khan	5	10	0	4	0	0	0	0	2	3	0	0
3	Tank	20	2	2	3	0	3	0	0	5	1	0	0
4	Lakki	12	0	0	1	9	1	3	7	6	1	1	0
5	Karak	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	2	0	0
6	N. Waziristan	53	8	5	1	0	0	10	1	3	1	2	0
7	S. Waziristan	56	3	0	3	2	0	3	0	7	8	2	0
	Total:	159	26	7	13	18	10	26	18	28	24	11	0

Annex 8

Security Letter by Dorsch Impact and KfW Response Letter



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RRMiC, RIF-II, UPPU
P&D Department
37-D, Circular Lane, University Town, Peshawar,
Pakistan. Postal Code: 25000

Subject: RIF II - Security Situation in D.I. Khan and Bannu districts

Dear Ms Pohl, Ms. Götzinger-Henschke, Mr Khan and Mr Saleh,

We write to you on behalf of Dorsch Impact in our capacity as Project Implementing Consultant for the *Resilience Improvement Framework Phase II (RIF-II)* project, currently underway in the Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (KP) province of Pakistan.

As you are aware, RIF-II has been operational since August 2024 in five of the nine accessible tehsils of D.I. Khan and Bannu Districts. Throughout this period, our team has remained engaged and committed to the project's objectives, while operating under a dynamic and, at times, challenging security environment.

With this letter we would like to bring to your attention that recent developments, including a series of security-related incidents in Dera Ismail Khan Division and Bannu Division as well as adjacent areas, have prompted increased concern within our field team and among our security staff. Based on their assessments and recommendations, certain field activities have been temporarily paused or carried out remotely as a precautionary measure. This includes limiting travel through specific corridors and adjusting planned visits in high-risk zones to ensure the safety of our personnel.

Currently implementation of the inception phase is ongoing, but subject to growing constraints. Activities in accessible areas are progressing, and remote coordination has been carried out in areas currently considered inaccessible. However, as the project transitions into stages requiring in-person engagement – such as community mapping workshops and infrastructure planning and construction – these inherently require field presence, which becomes increasingly difficult also in the so-called accessible tehsils.

In case security situation remains unchanged or deteriorates further, the question of how to ensure the efficient and effective use of project resources will come into focus as remote work becomes a less feasible option to maintain momentum toward the intended outcomes of the project. Under such circumstances, adjustments in geographic focus, implementation modalities, or timelines may be necessary.

Based on direct input from the ground, including urgent recommendations from our security experts, we must express serious reservations about the effectiveness of future operations under these conditions. As an international implementing partner, we rely fundamentally on the assessments and safety protocols advised by our own field staff and security personnel. Our intention is to maintain a constructive and collaborative approach, and we believe it is in the collective interest of all parties to address the current situation with clarity and coordination.

In the light of the above, and in view of discussions held during the KfW mission in April 2025, we respectfully suggest a dialogue for the ongoing implementation under the current circumstances and would welcome the opportunity to align on possible next steps.



We remain committed to the success of the RIF-II project and working jointly with all project partners. Your guidance at this juncture will be essential for navigating this sensitive phase in a manner that protects both personnel and project integrity.

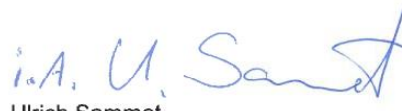
We thank you in advance for your understanding and look forward to your considered response.

Yours sincerely,

Dorsch Impact GmbH



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Date: 27 June 2025

German Financial Cooperation with Pakistan
Regional Infrastructure Fund for Khyber Pakhtunkhwa phase-II (RIF-II)
EUR 17,500,000
BMZ No. 201868355

Dear Additional Chief Secretary

This letter offers insights into the predicament of Regional Infrastructure Fund II (RIF-II) and provides KfW's stance on the proposed extension of project measures into Miryan tehsil in Bannu district of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (KP).

It gives us immense pleasure reiterating the importance of RIF-II as a strategic German investment in developing critical public service delivery gaps in Dera Ismail Khan and Bannu districts. Building up on the experience of RIF-KP and the Mansehra pilot in KP, this project aspires the development of integrated drinking water and waste management infrastructure in nine regions (tehsils) of Dera Ismail Khan and Bannu.

Towards the realization of this development objective, KfW jointly with Urban Policy Unit (UPU) has successfully mobilized the project implementation consultant (PIC) Dorsch Impact in August 2024. The appointment of a full-time Project Director in January 2025 provided a necessary stimulus towards project planning. The establishment of a Project Management Unit at UPU is a work in progress, involving the procurement of enabling equipment and appointment of required sectoral / technical expertise, which will further improve coordination.

The implementation consultant has completed the inception phase by undertaking some preliminary exercises, including stakeholder mapping, institutional analysis, and security assessment. The consultant is currently working on terms of reference for the project's social mobilization initiative, considering community engagement as an integral aspect of service provision in the rural settings of Dera Ismail Khan and Bannu, and an initial procurement plan.



Despite the best efforts of stakeholders, progress has remained suboptimal because of the adverse circumstances and challenges. These issues emanate primarily from the increasing insecurity and volatility in Dera Ismail Khan and Bannu. In PIC's analysis, only four areas have remained accessible where project activities could be pursued piecemeal. The remaining five tehsils under the PIC contract have remained beyond reach especially longer-term engagement with target communities and other stakeholders. The implementation consultant could not deploy requisite international and national experts on safety and security concerns. The PIC has expressed these concerns and limitations in writing, which is attached herewith for your perusal.

We fully appreciate these risks and endorse the PIC concerns. Under the financial cooperation, we take personnel, social and investment safeguards very seriously. Considering the nature of RIF-II measures, longer-term engagement and presence on the ground with stakeholders – public agencies, civil society and beneficiaries – is very critical just as the deployment of subcontractors and other services providers for the execution of infrastructure works. For KfW, investment safety and sustainability of measures (infrastructure) is equally critical just as important is timely completion of the project.

In April 2025, we (KfW, PIC and Project Executing Agency, including UPU and P&D Department) jointly reviewed the RIF-II predicament and considered the way forward. We mutually agreed on initiating activities in accessible tehsils including CSO contracting for community mobilization, stakeholder engagement and consultation, needs identification and validation, and infrastructure planning and implementation. We will simultaneously continue assessing the security situation in the currently inaccessible and insecure tehsils, including Miryan, over the next six months (until October/November 2025). The PIC will also formulate alternatives, including proposing possible inclusion of other districts in KP, for RIF-II. Based on the security assessment and plausible alternatives, KfW and the PEA will chalk a way forward for RIF-II – among others, amending the Separate Agreement, revising the PC-I, and reviewing the PIC contract.

We understand the KP Government's position on the exclusion of Miryan tehsil, which the PEA has communicated informally. The Project Director and other P&D Department colleagues have persistently advocated this. While many tehsils within the scope of PIC contract remain inaccessible, we consider this expectation unrealistic on many plains. Contractually, this will require an amendment of the PIC contract and even prior a consent on putting its staff and assets in harm's way. In April 2025, we agreed on observing and assessing the situation in Miryan, which shall be considered as part of other potential readjustment options for RIF-II later this year.

For your perusal, this letter encloses detailed minutes of meeting for the April 2025 consultation that took place in Islamabad. Considering the prevailing situation and scale of volatility, we appreciate your understanding and support towards finding a constructive